

Sayings of Cardinal Newman

John Henry Cardinal Newman

A gathering of memorable sayings from Newman's works, letters, and conversation. Collected 1890.

The text is in the public domain. Newman's notes are set as footnotes at their points of reference.

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Sayings of Cardinal Newman

A Collection of Speeches and Sermons delivered by His Eminence on occasions of interest during his Catholic life

About Poetry

In a lecture delivered in 1849, at St. Chad's Schools, Birmingham, "on the characteristics of Poetry,"

DR. NEWMAN began by saying that to speak of so difficult and so large a subject as poetry was an effort of ambition; for when persons came to consider what poetry was, and what a poet was, there were so many different opinions that it was very difficult to decide between them. Again, it seemed as if some authority were wanting for speaking of poetry at all, for many persons now considered that poetry was a thing of a former, a bygone age, and thought that the useful arts ought now alone to be pursued. For those who had pursued the useful arts it would be absurd not to entertain the highest reverence. But the useful arts did not cultivate the mind. This was the province of literature, of poetry, and of criticism; these refined the mind by making it what it was not before, and thus obviated the distinction between the higher and the lower classes; for now anyone might secure the advantages of intellectual attainments, which had been formerly confined to those who had had what was called a liberal education. After all, however, the useful arts were so necessary and profitable, that they still held sway; but when a man had mastered their elements, he put aside the books from which he had gleaned the information, he might, indeed, even sell them. There was no inclination to repeat their tasks, unless for the sake of perfection; there was in them no attractive beauty; they were merely the teachers of the principles of his employment. Now poetry always delighted, for poetry was the science of the beautiful. A book of poetry was one they would never part with, for it might be read with pleasure again and again. It was, emphatically, the beautiful which refined and cultivated the mind; and by long contemplation of beauty, the mind itself, so to speak, became beautiful in the process. The question with the poet was not whether what he treated of was true or consistent, so far as reasoning went, but whether it was beautiful. The poet's province was to colour objects; others coloured objects, too, but the poet coloured them with loveliness. Wordsworth had asserted that a child was the only true poet, and had pictured in one of his poems a child with all the poetry of childhood thrown around him, yet gradually losing these associations as he grew older, until when he arrived at manhood he became a mere ordinary mortal. The lecturer then proceeded to show how much poetry the active mind of the poet threw around common things; quoting, as illustrations, the description of the life of a good physician in one of Fouqué's works, and Goldsmith's beautiful and well-known description of an ale-house. The latter he powerfully contrasted with Wilkie's picture of the "Village Festival," in which the coarse, rough, yet true features of the scene were too faithfully rendered. This difference arose from the fact that while Goldsmith described a common object in beautiful terms, Wilkie, who had nothing poetical in him, merely gave us a literal transcript of the object itself. Wilkie took things from the life, but there was no new life cast over them; all his works were true, but none of them were beautiful. This would be seen from his portraits, which were frequently so true as to appear mere caricatures. They were utterly destitute of that higher dignity which a great master, who was possessed of poetical feelings, imparted to his portraits. He was now about to speak of Milton. In his greatest work, the "Paradise Lost" (of which, though they might not remember its details, the magnificent framework yet remained present to their minds), he had, unfortunately, as was truly remarked by Dryden,

made Satan not only his principal character, but actually his hero. The poetry of Milton's mind had made the evil spirits beautiful, and this was wrong, and even dangerous, as wherever evil was poetised it was a dangerous departure from truth, not only theological and religious, but even moral. This principle was exemplified in Byron's "Cain," where the character of the first murderer had been made an attractive one; and when Byron was censured for this, he defended himself by the example of Milton, who had made Satan poetical. Dr. Newman here read Milton's descriptions of Satan and Beelzebub, observing that so long as pride might be made seductive by the poet, so long also would there be poetry evil in its tendencies, in which the worst vices might be poetised. Still, this only proved his assertion that poetry was the perception, and the poetical art was the expression, of the beautiful; for vice could be rendered attractive in poetry solely by enduing it with some of the attributes of beauty. Into the definition of beauty he would not then enter, but he would content himself with mentioning a few principal points which beauty must comprise. The first principle was harmony; nothing eccentric could be beautiful—nothing extravagant, out of the way, or far-fetched. Proportion was another characteristic; for if one object was made too prominent the effect would be similar to that of the principal figure of a fine group cast forward in shadow by the sun—it would become grotesque. Pomposity was, too, very destructive of poetry. This was the great fault of Byron. A higher measure of justice than was usually shown on earth also marked poetical beauty. They had all heard of poetic justice, and this simply meant that matters were more evenly balanced in poetry than in human life; for poetry mainly consisting of tales, they generally found the good rewarded and the evil punished at the conclusion of the story. This principle would militate against tragedies, which, by terminating with horrors, violated the idea of poetical justice. A peculiarly painful instance of this was the tragedy of "Titus Andronicus," ascribed (though he believed falsely) to Shakspeare. The effects of poetry were to move the affections; for what was the effect of loveliness itself, but to move the affections? It was the view of the beauty of the Supreme Being that excited the affections and constituted the happiness of the Saints, and all things good and fair were but reflections of the fairness of God. They might recollect the charming line in the "Merchant of Venice," uttered by Jessica, when seated by moonlight in the garden at Belmont:

I am never merry when I hear sweet music.

Here music was the poetry, and stirred the affection which produced the result of pleasing melancholy. In Southey's "Thalaba" an exquisite episode was formed by the story of a witch who had not so totally given herself over to the power of the evil spirits but that she had a principle of recovery within her. She was represented as going from her dwelling out into the silent night and the calm, still beauty of everything around her—the sky, the stars, the whole face of nature—gave her the first principle of repentance, and became to her the instrument of conversion. There were two kinds of great poets, by whom poetry was exercised on two themes—on nature and on man. By nature, he meant the physical creation; by man, all that related to the human race. If they took the two great poets of antiquity, Homer and Virgil, they would see that Virgil was the poet of nature, Homer of man. In our own day, Wordsworth was a true poet of nature, Southey was a poet of society. They might call Wordsworth a philosopher, but no one would call Walter Scott's poetry philosophical; and even if they called Shakspeare a philosopher, it would only be for his deep knowledge of human nature. In short, the poets of nature were philosophers; the poets of society were men of the world and men of action, and necessarily men of deep acquaintance with the varying phases of human character. In Scott's delineation of the White Lady of Avenel, in his novel of "The Monastery," they had an instance of a poet of society trenching upon the province of

a poet of nature, and, as might be expected, making a complete failure. The idea of the White Lady was borrowed from Fouqué's "Undine," but Scott was unable to preserve the German idea in its spiritual form. From what he had said, it was plain that all colouring was not truly poetical. Nature might be looked at in many different aspects. Thus the naturalist would regard a natural object simply as holding a certain position in the economy of the universe; the geologist would deduce from its presence the existence of certain states of being; the physician would treat it simply as regarded its medicinal powers; while the painter would look to it as presenting some new phase of beauty. Thus things might be closely treated of, and highly coloured, without poetry. Crabbe taught us that accuracy of description was not poetry, for his descriptions, though remarkably life-like and accurate, were yet far removed from beauty. The Hindu mythology sufficiently showed that the mere monstrosity of greatness was not poetical—it possessed vastness without sublimity, for sublimity was nothing more than that amount of vastness which was compatible with beauty. The great ingredient of poetry, without which, indeed, it could not exist, was imagination, but there was much imagination which was unbeautiful. This again was a fault of Byron, whose imagination constantly led him into misanthropy; whereas true poetry partook of gentleness, simplicity, sweetness, and even playfulness; nay, melancholy might exist, but never misanthropy.

On Receiving a Batch of Converts from Anglicanism

Sermon preached at St. Ann's, Leeds, in 1851, at the reception into the Church of the Rev. Richard Ward, late Vicar of St. Saviour's, Leeds; the Rev. Thomas Minster, late Vicar of St. Saviours; the Revv. J. C. L. Crawley, S. Rooke, and Coombes, all Curates of St. Saviour's; the Rev. W. H. Lewthwaite, Incumbent of Clifford, near Tadcaster; the Rev. W. Neville, Manager of St. Saviour's Orphanage; and fourteen lay persons.

ADDRESSING those present as dear friends and brethren, DR. NEWMAN said this was no time for putting into order any thoughts which might be in his mind; nor, indeed, was it necessary, nor would they wish it. What they wished rather was that he should speak out of the fulness of his heart and there leave the matter. Because what was it that they who had that day been brought into the Catholic Church had received? They had received day for night, light for twilight, peace for warfare. There was not a change so great as that which took place from the state of doubt and confusion and misery in which the soul was, external to the Catholic Church, to that peace which it found when it came into it. They knew it was said there is a silence which can be heard, which can be felt. Anyone who had been at sea, and who had for days and nights heard the billows beating at the sides of the vessel, and then came into port, knew what a strange stillness it was when the continued noise of the billows had ceased. When a bell stopped there was a kind of fulness of silence which was most grateful from the contrast. So it was in comparing the tumult and irritation of mind, which they felt in their long seeking for peace, with the joy experienced when they had found it. It was the rich reward of their long anxieties. Those who did not care whether they were right or wrong, those who thought they were right, those who had a dead conscience—they had no anxiety; but it was when a ray of light came, it was when a wounded conscience stung them, it was when they had a misgiving that they were where they should not be—it was then that the warfare began. They had a feeling of duty and wished to do that duty, but they did not know where it lay. Sometimes they thought it lay this way, sometimes that way; and then the voices of friends came and over-persuaded them, and they were driven back; so that one way and another they were in a most miserable condition. It was partly, certainly, their own fault. It was the fault of all of them, doubtless, who had been external to the Catholic Church, that they did not enter it sooner, because

if they had had a fuller determination to follow God's will doubtless they would have found it sooner. But Almighty God knew what they were made of, and He mercifully led them on by first one grace and then another, till they were brought nearer and nearer to that haven where they would be. But though they might be getting nearer they did not know where they stood. Others might see they were getting nearer, but to themselves they seemed to be drifted about, tossed up and down by the waves, and there seemed no hope. It often happened that when persons were near the shore they were amongst billows more alarming and more dangerous, because Satan blew the billows more fiercely in order to drown those who were near safety; and they knew that frequently in cases of shipwreck when those who fell into the water were endeavouring to reach the land something happened to carry them off. So it was in like manner that poor souls who were making towards that land where they wished to be might be seen going on gradually and gradually towards the shore, and it might be prophesied—humbly, but still prophesied—that they would be landed safe, and alas! when they were about to land, suddenly they drifted off; they perished, and it was not known what became of them. It was only known that they were not landed on the beach of the Catholic Church. But the Catholics present had all cause for rejoicing that to those to whom God's mercy had been shown that day it had not so happened. They had put themselves into God's hands, and God had brought them into that haven which they had sought. And now on this day they thanked God, as they well might, that He had, in His grace, received them safe. He had brought them within the fold of His Church, He had encompassed them with His everlasting armour, had shielded them from the enemy, and he trusted that they had now got a gift they would never lose; that they were now in a state from which they would never fall, and, through God's mercy, having long sought, having at last found, they would go on from strength to strength, grace to grace, doing more and more in His service, and whatever might be their trials, still they would persevere to the end, and die in the Faith, and so would be brought, through the blood and merits of Jesus Christ, to the land of glory in eternity. What a time was this, that such a thing should take place in it! What did they see? They saw the evil spirit stirred up from the four winds. They saw he was blowing from the four quarters of Heaven upon this land, to make the waves of the people rise against the Catholic Church. They might say, "This is not the time for the Catholic Church to triumph." But it was the time. Man's necessity was God's opportunity. The darker the day was, the brighter God's light came. Did they not know it was the property of the truth of God to advance against wind and tide in the most rapid way? It advanced against all the billows because it was divine—it was supernatural. That was the property of the truth of God, and, therefore, just at this season, when men were most furious against them, when they told all manner of lies and falsehoods against them—because Christ was with them when men were so inflamed against them, it was the very time for them to expect triumphs. The world could not conquer: it was impossible. No, they would see, as time went on, that all those things which now looked so black and unpromising would turn to the glory and the salvation of the Catholic Church. If men were called to do that which he did not think they meant to do—persecute the Catholics—it would not hurt them. Did they not know, in the three first centuries of Christianity, that the martyrs went through so much for Christianity that it was said the blood of the martyrs was the seed of the Church? So was it now. Supposing men were mad enough to inflict chains and imprisonment upon them, it would only increase the spread of truth. Of course, it was unpleasant to live in the continued anxiety which all this tumult amid opposition created. Catholics did not like to be taken from their usual occupations. Catholics did not like to be taken from their usual religious ceremonies. Bishops did not like to be taken from their flocks. They wished for peace. They wished

for peace for the good of the world and for the good of their flocks internally. But would this state of warfare diminish the Church? No; it would increase it. Not a day passed but souls were received into the heart of the Catholic Church. Sometimes they might be high, sometimes they might be low, but the work could not be stopped. They recollected what Gamaliel said in the days of the Apostles. He said if the work was of man it would come to naught, but if it was of God it would go on, and they must take care they did not fight against it. So was it now. Here they were in the nineteenth century after Christ came into the world, and yet what was said by Gamaliel, 1,800 years ago, was fulfilled now. If this work was of man it would fall to naught. How was it that this work had gone on for 1,800 years, and now seemed more strong and flourishing for all the opposition which had existed against it? How was it that the Protestants were in such perplexity? Why, they had seen the Holy Father the Pope driven from Rome and obliged to take refuge elsewhere; they had seen him persecuted by his own people, and had said, "Here is a poor creature; he can do nothing." Catholics took them at their word. It was true the Pope was not strong in this world, and yet was strong; he suspected his strength must come, not from this, but from some other world, and he suspected it was from the throne of God. The words of Gamaliel were fulfilled. If the work was of man it would come to naught. It had not come to naught, and therefore it was not of man, but of God. He looked upon the converts present as specimens of this great miracle which is going on continually, this miracle of conversion of souls in spite of the opposition of the world. Every soul that was converted to God was converted by a miracle: it was a supernatural work which no power of man could do. It was a work of grace. It could not be worldly inducements which brought men into the Catholic Church, since they gained no riches, no honours, no praise from the mouths of men; but, on the contrary, they were reviled and called names. They gained nothing of this world. It was nothing, then, but a supernatural might which brought them in: it was nothing but the grace of God, seeing those things which the world could not see, and having a desire after those things which the world could not desire. That was the great distinction between the Catholic Church and every other body. Every other body depended upon the world. Take away its worldly support and it goes. There was no Protestant who would not grant, when he came to think, that the Church of England, for instance, would go to pieces directly the temporal support was taken away. It was impossible that it could stand. Protestants knew that very well. All the most sagacious knew it well. He recollected perfectly well, several years ago, a person in authority in the Church of England gave out a charge. What did he say? "The State is a very bad mistress, but we must put ourselves under its protection, and surrender ourselves to it, because we cannot get a better. It was once thought reason and intellect would help the Protestants against the Catholics; but we find it is not so. We find the cleverest men become Catholics. It was said that learning, talent, and genius would leave the Catholics, but it was not so. Light, learning, talent, and genius, all go towards the Catholic Church. Well, then nothing is left to us. Let us cling to the State because we cannot do anything better. Our only hope is a worldly hope; our only hope is in the arm of flesh, because we can find nothing better." Of course, those were not the very words, but the sentiment was nowise exaggerated. It was an honest and true sentiment, though it was very plain to come from a member of the Church of England. It was certain, if the protection of the State were taken from the Church of England it would crumble to pieces. Nothing would be left. It had no unity, no stability, no solidity, no existence, but in the power of the State. How different was the Catholic Church. The State did all it could against it, but it could not destroy it. Here was the State doing all it could against the Catholic Church, and yet the Catholic Church was growing in influence in the country. In spite of the State's having done so much for the Church of England, and so much

against the Catholic Church, still, when this poor old man, whom they professed to despise, living two thousand miles off, put out a bit of paper naming certain Bishops of England, the Church of England could not bear the shadow of his hand going over the country. He wrote a few words, the shadow of his hand went over the country, and the whole country was in commotion. The true Vicar of Christ, two thousand miles distant, put into confusion this great country. Could there be a better triumph for all of them than this fact? Their enemies and the inhabitants of their country (part were not their enemies) could not bear the very whisper of the Vicar of Christ in relation to this country; and in spite of all the greatness of the Church of England, they saw it was merely worldly, while the Catholic Church, not standing upon worldly power, rose up by an unseen power, a power which every arm of flesh feared. The State Church feared it, because it knew that it was of earth, and that the Church of God came from Heaven. It was to the preacher an affecting thing that he should be there on that occasion, speaking to them, because whom was it they had received into the Catholic Church that day? Why, it was the first of a portion of a special congregation of the Church of England, of a district or parish of the Church of England, which was created under remarkable circumstances—to him especially so. They knew he was not always a Catholic. It was some years ago the grace of God made him a Catholic, and on the very day of his conversion what was taking place in this town? Why, the very day when he was being led, as he trusted and believed by the grace of God, to embrace the Faith of the Church of Christ—that was the very time the Church of St. Saviour was opened. It was opened, if he recollected rightly, with a long devotional service which lasted many days, and when that was taking place here he was being received into the Catholic Church 150 miles away. Therefore it was to him a circumstance of especial interest just at this moment, now he was thrown back to the period of his own conversion, to see in the event of this day a sort of reward of what God led him to do then, that he had been the instrument in part of doing what had been done now. How or when it was that those favoured souls who had that day been made members of the Catholic Church were led by the grace of God towards the Catholic Church, he knew not; but as regarded himself, he felt that they had wished him to come as a kind of witness to receive them, because there was this remarkable connexion between St. Saviour's Church being opened and his own conversion. Then it was that that was begun which now had its end, and they saw in this another illustration of the want of stability of everything in the Church of England. There had been a church—he meant St. Saviour's—opened with how much of pious feeling, with how many sincere aspirations, with how many ready offerings to Almighty God. What sums of money had been expended upon that church. It had been the work of persons who in their hearts believed, in doing what they did, they were making an offering, not to the work of man, but to the Catholic church. They were mistaken in thinking so, but they brought their offerings. They did not act with a half liberality, but, bringing treasure by handfuls, they gave it for the erection of a church which they hoped would be a Catholic church. They adorned it, enriched it, and what had become of all those hopes which began six years ago? Why, had they not vanished into empty air? They saw that the church which they built had turned out to be nothing at all; and after a trial of six years there was that remarkable truth which came to him six years ago, that the Church of England was a mere shade, that it had no substance. Here was this trial which they saw had come to naught. There were piety, devotion, sincerity, earnestness—persons who would devote themselves earnestly to God; but alas! they built up the mere creation of this world, which would not last. It was coming to naught, and what had been the case here would be the case all over in the Church of England but for the power of the State. It was the power of the State which alone kept anything in its place in the Church of England. Not so with the Catholic Church. Merely sitting

still, ordering its own work silently, it had attracted educated members of the Church of England to it. It was a burning and a shining light, and it preached to the people directly by its example. After some further observations, Dr. Newman begged the prayers of the Catholics present for those who had been received into the Church on that day and some days previously. He begged their prayers that the work begun might go on spreading and increasing daily, till all those were brought into the fold of Christ that ought to belong to it—that all those to whom God had given grace might have the veil taken from their eyes. He asked their prayers also—for prayer was omnipotent—that all those who had anything to do with the erection of St. Saviour’s Church might be brought to the light of truth. They could not undo what they had done. St. Saviour’s Church, so called, was given up to the Protestants, and there was an end of it. They had given it over to the State. They could not undo their own work; but it would be a great thing for all of them, while they felt that they could not undo much that they had done, that at least they could save their own souls, and show their earnestness by retracing their steps as far as they could. He begged them to pray that every one of the earnest persons who preached sermons at the opening of St. Saviour’s Church might be brought into the fold of Christ; that all those who had hung upon their words might be brought fully to the truth; that those who, to some extent, had been nursing fathers to the Catholic Church, though they knew it not, might be brought in; and that every one who had been instrumental in the spread of Catholic doctrines in England, though they knew it not, might be brought into the Catholic Church. Finally, Dr. Newman asked his Catholic hearers to pray for himself that he might be enabled to do his share in the work which had been begun.

Accepting First Praise

At a crowded meeting held on September 8th, 1851, at the Corn Exchange, Birmingham, Bishop Ullathorne publicly thanked Dr. Newman for his course of nine lectures on “The Present Position of Catholics in England.” In reply,

DR. NEWMAN said he knew perfectly well that he ought to look for praise to God alone; but he thought the present was an exceptional case, and he therefore took what had been said—and with all humility he would say it—as an act of God’s love towards him. It was a curious thing for him to say, though he was now of mature age, and had been very busy in many ways, yet this was the first time in his life that he had ever received any praise. He had been in other places and done work elsewhere, before being a Catholic, but there was no response, no sympathy; it was not the fault of the people, for they could not respond. Some instruments could only make beautiful music, and some, from their very nature, could only make a noise. So it was with such a body as that to which he once belonged: they could only make a noise—no echo, no response, no beautiful music. But it was quite different when a man entered the Catholic Church. In conclusion, he entreated the prayers of those who heard him, as it was only the prayers of Catholics which could sustain him on this troubled ocean to that shore which they all hoped to reach through God’s blessing ¹.

¹The *Tablet* of July 5th, 1851, records that Dr. Newman delivered “the first of a series of lectures on ‘The State of Catholics in England’ in the Corn Exchange, High Street, Birmingham. The public were admitted by ticket; and among those present was the Rev. H. E. Manning (late Archdeacon).” Dr. Newman, who wore the habit of his Order, and was received with prolonged applause, read his lecture, and remained seated. The sixth lecture was attended by “several gentlemen from London, including Mr. J. L. Patterson,” now Bishop of Emmaus.

On Relinquishing the Rectorship of the Catholic University of Ireland

To the Vice-Rector, Professors, and Officers of the Catholic University of Ireland, in reply to an address which they had presented at Christmas, 1859—all address which bears, among many others, the signatures of John O'Hagan, B.A., Robert Ornsby, M.A., Thomas Arnold, B.A., Le Page Renouf, T.W. Allies, Aubrey de Vere, J. H. Pollen, M.A., and W. H. Anderdon, M.A.—Dr. Newman said: —

MY DEAR FRIENDS,—I am deeply grateful to you for the address which you have sent me. It comes to me on the last day of the year, and is a most acceptable and encouraging termination of it. The highest among the earthly rewards of exertion in any cause is to succeed in winning the approbation and attachment of fellow-labourers, who are our nearest witnesses and best qualified judges, as it is the first of trials to disappoint or displease them. You have given me this special gratification. I rather am the party who ought to make acknowledgments, remembering, as I do, so many instances of the heartiness and self-denying earnestness with which you supported me in the anxious work which brought us together. And I have to ask you to forgive my many shortcomings, excusing me, moreover, for venturing to commence what I avowed at the same time that I could not carry through, and making allowances for the imperfection of plans, which from the nature of the case, were but tentative and provisional. But to the generosity of your past co-operation you have added the fresh favour of your present affectionate leave-taking; and its expressions are too welcome to admit of my disputing them. I rejoice to know that I have made friends who, whether I see them often or no, will take all interest in whatever may be the will of Providence concerning me in time to come, and whom I may try to repay by remembering in His sight. I rejoice to believe that you represent others, too, known to me and unknown, who, together with you, will bear me in mind as years pass on, and will say a prayer for me when I am taken away. And I rejoice to have in my possession a testimonial, which I can deliver to my brothers here, to be preserved among their records, in honourable memory of the first Superior of this Oratory. And now nothing remains for me but to wish you all the best wishes of this sacred season, and all happy anticipations of the new year, you, and all yours, and the land in which you dwell, that home of warm and affectionate hearts, which, as you truly say, I have wished in my humble measure to serve, believing that in serving Ireland I was serving a country which had tokens in her of an important future and the promise of still greater works than she has yet achieved in the cause of the Catholic faith.

On the Occasion of Writing the “Apologia”

The Clergy assembled at the Diocesan Synod of Birmingham in June, 1864; presented an address with reference to the attack made by Charles Kingsley.

DR. NEWMAN replied as follows: He had in vain attempted to prepare an answer to it from the first time he learned it was the intention of the clergy of the diocese to confer upon him this most undeserved and unexpected honour; but as often as he had tried he had failed, and had at last given up the attempt in despair, and determined to trust to the moment. And now that the moment had come, what could he say except thank them, which he did most sincerely, for the great honour which they were doing him, and which, from the solemnity of the occasion, the sanctity of the place, and the venerable and sacred character of those who were so honouring him in the very presence of his Bishop, was the highest they could confer. They had spoken in their address of the service he had by his late work done to religion, but he must assure them that he did not himself feel that he had any claim to such high praise in the work which had called forth this address; he had but performed a duty which had been thrust upon him by circumstances over which he had no control;

if, however, in the vindication of his character he had indirectly done good by lessening prejudices against the Catholic clergy, or the Faith which was so dear to them all, of course he should be very grateful for this result. This, however, was not the way in which he would wish to consider the address (viz., as an acknowledgment of his services to religion); he preferred looking upon it (and he had the greatest pleasure in so looking upon it) as an expression of their warm affection and kindly sympathy towards himself, when they saw he was in trouble. It was, indeed, the greatest comfort and support to him to have their sympathy at the present moment; nor was it the first time they had stood by him when he was in need of their countenance and aid. It had happened to him upon a former occasion to be threatened with a great trial upon the delivery of some lectures in this town, when, on the delivery of the last of those lectures, the clergy, hearing of the trial in which he was likely to be involved, headed by a venerable man whom he always remembered with the greatest reverence and affection, their late Provost, Dr. Weedall, came forward and gave him their support. He said in the last of those lectures that it mattered little what people at a distance thought of us, if those amongst whom we lived loved and honoured us. Those amongst whom he (Dr. Newman) lived had shown the truth of this remark *then*, and they were confirming its truth *now*. Whatever people who did *not* know him thought of him, he was sure of the affection and esteem of those who did know him. This was a great comfort to him, for although it was our duty to look for comfort principally in the thought of Our Lord and in the prayers of the Saints, yet still it was permitted us to receive consolation from each other, and he deeply thanked them all for the support they had thus given him in this time of trial. And it was this view he took of them as his friends in need, that gave him the right to say that he feared he should disappoint their expectations with regard to his future labours in defence of the truth against the prevailing errors of the day. He felt there were many things which led him to think that the time was not come to speak, and that he was not the man to speak. First, the very errors themselves were so vague, so self-destructive, that if the Church endeavoured to combat them in their present shape she would be like one "who beateth the air," and that perhaps before the armour which was to be used in her defence was forged the difficulties would have destroyed each other. Then the Church moved slowly in her majestic march she had ever taken time. Four centuries had passed away from her commencement, and though she had great Saints and learned men, she had allowed the calumnies of the world to pass unheeded, till God raised up St. Augustine to answer all objections hitherto urged, and many that should be urged in future ages down to our own time. When the time came, God would raise up such a one to defend the Church's teaching. But now our duty was patience, the Church's business seemed to be to show the world what a devoted clergy could do by spending their lives and energy in missionary labours. Then as to himself, it seemed to him that old age was more for suffering than for action, and thus it was in some sense a beginning of purgatory; and as prayers had so special a power in liberating from purgatory, when a soul could do nothing for itself, he felt that their prayers were the one thing which could do him a service now.

On Certain Aspersions

In reply to an influentially signed address of confidence, at a time when certain aspersions were thrown on his name, Dr. Newman, in writing, at the close of 1867, thus addressed the Right Hon. W. Monsell, afterwards Lord Emly:

I ACKNOWLEDGE without delay the honour done me in the memorial addressed to me by so many Catholic noblemen and gentlemen, which you have been the medium of conveying to me. The attacks of opponents are never hard to bear when the person who is the subject of them is

conscious to himself that they are undeserved; but in the present instance I have small cause indeed for pain or regret at this occurrence, since they have at once elicited in my behalf the warm feeling of so many dear friends who know me well, and of so many others whose good opinion is the more impartial, for the very reason that I am not personally known to them. Of such men, whether friends or strangers to me, I would a hundred times rather receive the generous sympathy than have escaped the misrepresentations which are the occasion of their showing it. I rely on you, my dear Monsell, who from long intimacy understand me so well, to make clear to them my deep and lasting gratitude in fuller terms than it is possible within the limits of a formal acknowledgment to express it.

At the Funeral of Henry W. Wilberforce

From the letter of one who was present at the funeral of Mr. Henry Wilberforce at the Dominican Monastery at Woodchester, in 1873:

DURING the office a venerable figure came quietly up the aisle, and was going meekly to take a place on the chairs at the side; but H—— saw and took him into the sacristy, whence he soon made his appearance in cassock and cotta in the choir, and was conducted to the Prior's stall, which was vacated for him. This was dear Dr. Newman. He followed the office with them, but after awhile could contain his tears no longer, and buried his face in his handkerchief. At the end of Mass, Father Bertrand said something to Dr. Newman, and, after a little whispering, the venerable man was conducted to the pulpit. For some minutes, however, he was utterly incapable of speaking, and stood, his face covered with his hands, making vain efforts to master his emotion. I was quite afraid he would have to give it up. At last, however, after two or three attempts, he managed to steady his voice, and to tell us "that he knew him so intimately and loved him so much, that it was almost impossible for him to command himself sufficiently to do what he had been so unexpectedly asked to do, viz., to bid his dear friend farewell. He had known him for fifty years, and though, no doubt, there were some there who knew his goodness better than he did, yet it seemed to him that no one could mourn him more." Then he drew a little outline of his life—of the position of comfort and all "that this world calls good," in which he found himself, and of the prospect of advancement, "if he had been an ambitious man." "Then the word of the Lord came to him, as it did to Abraham of old, to go forth from that pleasant home, and from his friends, and all he held dear, and to become——" here he fairly broke down again, but at last, lifting up his head, finished his sentence—"a fool for Christ's sake." Then he said that he now "committed him to the hands of his Saviour," and he reminded us of "the last hour, and dreadful judgment, which awaited us all, but which his dear brother had safely passed through," and earnestly and sweetly prayed "that every one there present might have a holy and happy death."

On Receiving Notice of His Elevation to the Sacred College

In reply to the messenger bearing the *biglietto* from the Cardinal Secretary of State, containing the notice of his elevation to the Cardinalate, whom he received at the house of Cardinal Howard, May 17th, 1879,

CARDINAL NEWMAN said: I ask your permission to continue my address to you, not in your musical language, but in my own dear mother tongue; it is because in the latter I can better express my feelings on this most gracious announcement which you have brought to me than if I attempted what is above me. First of all, then, I am led to speak of the wonder and profound gratitude which come upon me, and which is upon me still, at the condescension and love towards me of the Holy

Father in singling me out for so immense an honour. It was a great surprise. Such an elevation had never come into my thoughts, and seemed to be out of keeping with all my antecedents. I had passed through many trials, but they were over, and now the end of all things had almost come to me and I was at peace. And was it possible that, after all, I had lived through so many years for this? Nor is it easy to see how I could have borne so great a shock had not the Holy Father resolved on a second condescension towards me, which tempered it, and was to all who heard of it a touching evidence of his kindly and generous nature. He felt for me, and he told me the reasons why he raised me to this high position. His act, said he, was a recognition of my zeal and good services for so many years in the Catholic cause. Moreover, he judged it would give pleasure to English Catholics, and even to Protestant England, if I received some mark of his favour. After such gracious words from His Holiness, I should have been insensible and heartless if I had had scruples any longer. This is what he had the kindness to say to me, and what could I want more? in a long course of years I have made many mistakes. I have nothing of that high perfection which belongs to the writings of Saints, namely, that error cannot be found in them; but what I trust I may claim throughout all that I have written is this—an honest intention, an absence of private ends, a temper of obedience, a willingness to be corrected, a dread of error, a desire to serve the Holy Church, and, through the Divine mercy, a fair measure of success. And, I rejoice to say, to one great mischief I have from the first opposed myself. For thirty, forty, fifty years I have resisted, to the best of my powers, the spirit of Liberalism in religion. Never did the Holy Church need champions against it more sorely than now, when, alas! it is an error overspreading as a snare the whole earth; and on this great occasion, when it is natural for one who is in my place to look out upon the world and upon the Holy Church as it is and upon her future, it will not, I hope, be considered out of place if I renew the protest against it which I have so often made. Liberalism in religion is the doctrine that there is no positive truth in religion, but that one creed is as good as another, and this is the teaching which is gaining substance and force daily. It is inconsistent with the recognition of any religion as true. It teaches that all are to be tolerated, as all are matters of opinion. Revealed religion is not a truth, but a sentiment and a taste—not an objective fact, not miraculous; and it is the right of each individual to make it say just what strikes his fancy. Devotion is not necessarily founded on faith. Men may go to Protestant churches and to Catholic, may get good from both, and belong to neither. They may fraternise together in spiritual thoughts and feelings without having any views at all of doctrine in common or seeing the need of them. Since, then, religion is so personal a peculiarity and so private a possession, we must of necessity ignore it in the intercourse of man with man. If a man puts on a new religion every morning, what is that to you? It is as impertinent to think about a man's religion as about the management of his family. Religion is in no sense the bond of society. Hitherto the civil power has been Christian. Even in countries separated from the Church, as in my own, the *dictum* was in force when I was young that Christianity was the law of the land. Now everywhere that goodly framework of society, which is the creation of Christianity, is throwing off Christianity. The *dictum* to which I have referred, with a hundred others which followed upon it, is gone or is going everywhere, and by the end of the century, unless the Almighty interferes, it will be forgotten. Hitherto it has been considered that religion alone, with its supernatural sanctions, was strong enough to secure the submission of the mass of the population to law and order. Now, philosophers and politicians are bent on satisfying this problem without the aid of Christianity. Instead of the Church's authority and teaching they would substitute, first of all, a universal and a thoroughly secular education, calculated to bring home to every individual that to be orderly, industrious, and sober is his personal interest. Then, for great

working principles to take the place of religion for the use of the masses thus carefully educated, they provide the broad, fundamental, ethical truths of justice, benevolence, veracity, and the like, proved experience, and those natural laws which exist and act spontaneously in society and in social matters, whether physical or psychological—for instance, in government, trade, finance, sanitary experiments, the intercourse of nations. As to religion, it is a private luxury which a man may have if he will, but which, of course, he must pay for, and which he must not obtrude upon others or indulge to their annoyance. The general character of this great apostasy is one and the same everywhere, but in detail and in character it varies in different countries. For myself, I would rather speak of it in my own country, which I know. There, I think, it threatens to have a formidable success, though it is not easy to see what will be its ultimate issue. At first sight it might be thought that Englishmen are too religious for a movement which on the Continent seems to be founded on infidelity; but the misfortune with us is that, though it ends in infidelity, as in other places, it does not necessarily arise out of infidelity. It must be recollected that the religious sects which sprang up in England three centuries ago, and which are so powerful now, have ever been fiercely opposed to the union of Church and State, and would advocate the unchristianising the monarchy and all that belongs to it, under the notion that such a catastrophe would make Christianity much more pure and much more powerful. Next, the liberal principle is forced on us through the necessity of the case. Consider what follows from the very fact of these many sects. They constitute the religion, it is supposed, of half the population; and recollect, our mode of government is popular. Every dozen men taken at random whom you meet in the streets have a share in political power. When you inquire into their forms of belief perhaps they represent one or other of as many as seven religions. How can they possibly act together in municipal or in national matters if each insists on the recognition of his own religious denomination? All action would be at a deadlock unless the subject of religion were ignored. We cannot help ourselves. And, thirdly, it must be borne in mind that there is much in the liberalistic theory which is good and true; for example, not to say more, the precepts of justice, truthfulness, sobriety, self-command, benevolence, which, as I have already noted, are among its avowed principles. It is not till we find that this array of principles is intended to supersede, to block out, religion, that we pronounce it to be evil. There never was a device of the enemy so cleverly framed and with such promise of success. And already it has answered to the expectations which have been formed of it. It is sweeping into its own ranks great numbers of able, earnest, virtuous men—elderly men of approved antecedents, young men with a career before them. Such is the state of things in England, and it is well that it should be realised by all of us; but it must not be supposed for a moment that I am afraid of it. I lament it deeply, because I foresee that it may be the ruin of many souls; but I have no fear at all that it really can do aught of serious harm to the work of truth, to the Holy Church, to our Almighty King, the Lion of the tribe of Judah, faithful and true, or to His Vicar on earth. Christianity has been too often in what seemed deadly peril, that we should fear for it any new trial now. So far is certain. On the other hand, what is uncertain, and in these great contests commonly is uncertain, and what is commonly a great surprise when it is witnessed, is the particular mode in the event by which Providence rescues and saves His elect inheritance. Sometimes our enemy is turned into a friend; sometimes he is despoiled of that special virulence of evil which was so threatening; sometimes he falls to pieces of himself; sometimes he does just so much as is beneficial and then is removed. Commonly the Church has nothing more to do than to go on in her own proper duties in confidence and peace, to stand still, and to see the salvation of God. *Mansueti hereditabunt terram et delectabuntur in multitudine pacis.*

On Being Congratulated

Replying to an address read by Lady Herbert of Lea, in Rome on the occasion of the presentation of a set of vestments, jeweled mitre, and altar candlesticks from the English Colony, in May, 1879, Cardinal Newman said:

MY DEAR FRIENDS,—Your affectionate address, introductory to so beautiful a present, I accept as one of those strange favours of Divine Providence which are granted to few. Most men, if they do any good, die without knowing it; but I call it strange that I should be kept to my present age—an age beyond the age of most men—as if in order that, in this great city, where I am personally almost unknown, I might find kind friends to meet me with an affectionate welcome and to claim me as their spiritual benefactor. The tender condescension to me of the Holy Father has elicited in my behalf, in sympathy with him, a loving acclamation from his faithful children. My dear friends, your present, which while God gives me strength I shall avail myself of in my daily Mass, will be a continual memento in His sight both of your persons and of your several intentions. When my strength fails me for that great action, then in turn I know well that I may rely on your taking up the duty and privilege of intercession, and praying for me that, with the aid of the Blessed Virgin and all Saints, I may persevere in faith, hope, and charity, and in all that grace which is the life of the soul, till the end comes.

On the Kindness of Ireland

In reply to an address of the Irish members of Parliament, read by Sir J. McKenna, to receive which Cardinal Newman came expressly to London in April, 1879,

HIS EMINENCE said: Gentlemen, this is a great day for me, and it is a day which gives me great pleasure too. It is a pleasure to meet old friends, and it is a pleasure to make new ones. But it is not merely as friends I meet you; for you are the representatives of a Catholic people. And, therefore, in receiving your congratulations, of course I feel very much touched by your address. But I hope you will not think it strange if I say that I have been surprised too; because, while it is a great thing to please one's own people, it is still more wonderful to create an interest in a people which is not one's own. I do not think there is any other country which could have treated me so graciously as you have done. It is now nearly thirty years since, with a friend of mine, I first went over to Ireland with a view to that engagement which I afterwards formed there, and during the seven years through which that engagement lasted I had a continued experience of kindness, and nothing but kindness, from all classes of people: from the Hierarchy, from the seculars and regulars, and from the laity, whether in Dublin or in the country. As their first act they helped me in a great trouble in which I was involved. I had put my foot into an unusual legal embarrassment, and it required many thousand pounds to draw me out of it. They took a great share in that work. Nor did they show less kindness at the end of my time. I was obliged to leave Ireland by the necessities of my own Congregation at Birmingham. Everybody can understand what a difficulty it is for a body to be without its head, and I had only engaged for seven years, because otherwise I could not fulfil the charge the Holy Father had put upon me in the Oratory. Not a word of disappointment or unkindness was uttered, when there might have been a feeling that I was relinquishing a work which I had begun. And now I repeat that, to my surprise, at the end of twenty years, I find a silent memory cherished of a person who can only be said to have meant well, though he did little. And now, what return can I make to show my gratitude? None that is sufficient. But this I can say, that your address will not die with me. I belong to a body which, with God's blessing, will live after me—the Oratory of St. Philip Neri. The parchment which is the record of your generosity shall be

committed to our archives, and shall testify to generations to come the enduring kindness of Irish Catholics towards the founder and first head of the English Oratory.

On the pleasant Care of Boys

In reply to an address read by Lord Edmund Talbot on July 21st, 1879, on behalf of the Oratory School Society,

CARDINAL NEWMAN said: I thank you very much for the address of congratulation which you have presented to me on the great dignity to which the Holy Father has raised me. Besides the honour, he has done me this great service, that his condescension has, in God's mercy, been the means of eliciting in my behalf so much kind sympathy, so much deep friendliness, so much sincere goodwill, of which the greater part was till now only silently cherished in the hearts of persons known and unknown to me. I do not mean to say that I did not believe in your affection for me; no, I have had many instances of it. I have rejoiced to know it, and I have been grateful to you for it; but I could not till I read your short and simple words realise its warmth, its depth, and what I may call its volume. Your letter is the best reward, short of supernatural, for much weariness and anxiety in time past. Nothing, indeed, is more pleasant than the care of boys; at the same time nothing involves greater responsibility. A school such as ours is a pastoral charge of the most intimate kind. Most men agree in judging that boys, instead of remaining at home, should be under the care of others at a distance. In order to the due formation of their minds, boys need that moral and intellectual discipline which school alone can give. Their parents, then, make a great sacrifice, and also make an act of supreme confidence, in committing their dear ones to strangers. You see, then, what has made us so anxious, sometimes too anxious—namely, our sense of the great trust committed to us by parents, and our desire to respond faithfully to the duties of that trust, as well as our love for, our interest in, our desire, if so be, to impart a blessing from above upon, their children. No other department of the pastoral office requires such sustained attention and such unwearied services. A confessor, for the most part, knows his penitents only in the confessional, and perhaps does not know them by sight. A parish priest knows, indeed, the members of his flock individually, but he sees them only from time to time. Day schools are not schools except in school hours, but the superiors in a school such as ours live with their pupils, and see their growth from day to day. They almost see them grow, and they are ever tenderly watching over them that their growth may be in the right direction. You see now why it is that the few words of your address are so great a comfort to me. Yes, they are a definite, formal answer to the questionings, searchings of heart, and anxieties of twenty years. Of course, I know that we have been wonderfully blessed in the set of boys whom we have had to work for—we have had a very good material. Also, I know when you speak so kindly of my personal influence and guidance that this is a reference to more than myself, and that I can only occupy the second or the third place in any success which we can claim. However, if to have desired your best good, if to have prayed for it, if to have given much time and thought towards its attainment deserves your acknowledgment, and has a call on your lasting attachment, I can, without any misgiving of conscience, accept in substance your affectionate language about me. Before concluding my thanks, I must express my great gratification at your splendid gift of vestments, munificent in itself, and most welcome as a lasting memento of July 20th, 1879, and of the address of congratulation with which that gift is accompanied.

On an Audience with the Pope

Acknowledging the presentation of a monstrance by Lady Alexander Lennox on behalf of the boys at the Oratory School, July 20th, 1879,

CARDINAL NEWMAN said: It is very difficult for me in set words to express the feelings of great gratitude and great gratification which such an address from such persons causes me. I have spoken in the answer I have just made to our late scholars—the members of the Oratory School Society—of the feelings which parents must have when they commit their children either to strangers or to those who at least cannot be so near and dear to them as those parents are themselves. I recollect perfectly well enough of my own childhood to know with what pain a mother loses her children for the first time, and is separated from them, not knowing for the time what may happen to them. It is, of course, an enormous gratification and a cause of thankfulness, where thanks are due, that I should be—that we should be—so kindly, considerately, and tenderly regarded as we are, and as that address which you have read to me brings out. Concerning our school, it may be pleasant to you to know that the Holy Father at Rome seemed to take great interest in it without my urging it upon him. I brought before him the outline of the history of the Oratory for the last thirty years, and he showed great interest in it, and, I may say, even mastered all I said; and I could see it remained in his mind, for when the time came for me and my friends the Fathers to be presented to him to take leave of him, then, though what I asked for was a blessing upon this house, and upon the house in London, he added of his own will, “And a blessing upon the school.” It was a thing he singled out; and as we have been blessed by the blessing of the holy Pope Pius IX. on the commencement of the Oratory, we may look forward to Divine aid for being guided and prospered in the time to come. I hope you will not measure my sense of your kindness to me by the few words I have spoken, for if I attempted to express my full feelings, I should have to detain you a long time before I came to an end. But loth as I am to detain you with more words, I must not conclude without offering you my best thanks for the magnificent monstrance which you, and others, as mothers of our boys, have had the kindness to present me in memory of my elevation to the Sacred College, or without assuring both you who are here and those whom you represent, how acceptable to us is this token of the interest you take in the past and present of the Oratory.

To the Oratory School Boys

To a congratulatory address read by Mr. Richard Pope on same date,

CARDINAL NEWMAN, in reply, said that the tribute of the boys, as the daily witnesses of his more private life, came home to him and touched him exceedingly. After referring in congratulatory terms to those boys who had left the school and gone forward in the career of life, and had fulfilled so well the duties of their station, the Cardinal concluded as follows: When I think of that, and think of you who are to go into the same world, and fight the same battles as they have done, I have great confidence that you, beginning with such tender feelings towards your teachers, and me especially, will answer all the expectations that we have formed of you, and the wishes that we have for you. I will say no more, but will thank you, and assure you that, as this day will remain in your mind, so it will remain in mine.

On the happy character of the Time

To an address from the chapter of Salford on July 21st, 1879,

CARDINAL NEWMAN replied as follows: In thanking the Chapter of Salford, through you, Monsignor Croskell, its Right Reverend Provost, for your most welcome congratulations on the dignity to which the Supreme Pontiff has graciously raised me, as I most heartily do, I thank you for bringing before the present hearers of your address, and before myself, the very apposite reflection—as regards such success as has attended me in what I have done or have written, whether in point of influence at home, or special and singular recognition on the part of the Holy Father at the centre of Catholicity—how much I owe to the happy character of the time. I myself, thirty or forty years ago, found it impossible to stem the current of popular feeling which was adverse from me, and found that patience and waiting was all that was left for me. But what a trifle of a difficulty was this compared with the real and terrible obstacles which confronted the Catholic champion in England in the sixteenth century. Now our enemies assail us only with gloves—not with gauntlets—and with foils with buttons on, and words that break no bones. Three centuries ago the weapons of controversy were of a deadly character; and how could even the most angelic sanctity, the most profound learning, the most persuasive talent, if embodied in the Catholic controversialist, preacher or priest, succeed against the rack, the gibbet, and the axe? how could he attain to any issue of his labour save that of martyrdom? Let us, then, my dear Right Reverend Provost, derive from this meeting and the brotherly love which takes place between us today what is indeed its true moral—that God has been very good to us His children, in this poor country, that we owe Him great gratitude, and that His past mercies are an earnest to us, unless we be unfaithful, of greater mercies to come. “The house of Aaron hath hoped in the Lord; He is their helper and protector. The Lord hath been mindful of us, and hath blessed us. He hath blessed the house of Israel, He hath blessed the house of Aaron.”

On his trepidation as an Author

An address of congratulation was read by Canon Toole, on behalf of the Manchester Catholic club, on July 21st, 1879.

IN response Cardinal NEWMAN said: Very Rev. Canon Toole and gentlemen associated with him,—I could not desire any secular rewards for such attempts as I have made to serve the cause of Catholic truth more complete and more welcome to me than the praise which is so kindly bestowed upon me in the address of the Manchester Catholic Club, now read to me by you, its representatives. There is, from the nature of the case, so much imperfection in all literary productions, and so much variety of opinion, sentiment, and ethical character in any large circle of readers, that whenever I have found it a duty to write and publish in defence of Catholic doctrine or practice I have felt beforehand a great trepidation lest I should fail in prudence, or err in statement of facts, or be careless in language; and afterwards, for the same reasons, I have been unable to feel any satisfaction at recurring in mind to my composition. That what I have said might have been said better, I have seen clearly enough—my own standard of excellence was sufficient to show me this. But to what positive praise it was entitled, that was for others to decide, and, therefore, when good Catholics, with divines of name and authority, come forward and tell me, as you do, that what I have published has been of great service to my dear mother the Holy Church, it is, I cannot deny, a great reassurance and gratification to me to receive such a testimony in my favour. I thank you, then, heartily for your congratulations on my elevation to the dignity of Cardinal, for your generous and, I may say, affectionate reference to my controversial writings, and for your prayers

on behalf of my health and continuance of life. The future is in God's hands. Anyhow, it is a great pleasure to think that the generation that is now passing away is leaving for that future so large, so fervent, so strong a succession of Catholics to hand down to posterity the sacred and glorious tradition of the one, true, ancient Faith.

To the Young Men's Society

To an address presented by the Rev. J. Sherlock for the Young Men's Society, August 8th, 1879, CARDINAL NEWMAN replied, turning to the Rev. J. Sherlock: My dear Father Sherlock,—I wish I had a hundredth part of your merit. It would be hard if one did not in one's little way try to serve one who is such a laborious, hard-working priest as you have been. The Lord bless you. Turning to the deputation the Cardinal said: You must have anticipated, I am sure, Gentlemen, before I say it, what gratification I feel at the address you have now presented to me on the occasion of my elevation by the condescending act of the Supreme Pontiff to the Sacred College of Cardinals. It has gratified me in many ways. I feel it is a great honour to be thus singled out for special notice by a body so widely extended, so important in its objects, so interesting to every Catholic mind, as your Society. Next, your address has come to me in a shape which enhances the compliment you pay me, and was sure to be most acceptable to me. Not only is the copy which you have put into my hands most beautifully illuminated, but the illuminations are made to memorialise the various passages in my life past, and seem to suggest the careful interest and the sympathy, and, I may say, the tenderness with which you yourselves have dwelt upon them. And then this address comes to me from so many. It is as strange to me as it is pleasing, to find, at the Holy Father's word, and, as it were, at his signal, a host of friends starting up and gathering and thronging round about me from so many towns, north and south, in this land. Whereas up to this time, widely known and highly accounted as has been your Society, for myself I have never realised that there was any personal tie between you and me, or had that conscious fellowship with you which is so great a help when hearts beat in unison as being associates and companions in a great and noble cause. Still further you add to the gratification which I feel on other accounts, by telling me that one of my books has been of use to you in your zealous efforts to defend and propagate Catholic truth, and, although I have not known you, you, on the other hand, have known me. And, more than this, in speaking of those lectures of mine, you do not forget to notice that they come from the Oratory of St. Philip Neri, in whose house you are now assembled. I am glad to recognise with you the similarity of aims which exists in the work of our glorious Saint, who lived three centuries ago in Italy, and that of the excellent priest who has been in this century and in these islands the founder of the Young Men's Society, and I cannot help feeling some satisfaction in observing in your address, and, as it were, in the aspect of your Society, certain coincidences, in themselves indeed trivial, and what may be called matters of sentiment, yet to me happy accidents, as a sort of token of some subtle sympathy connecting you with the Oratory. Such, for instance, is the date you have affixed to your address (the Feast of St. Augustine, Apostle of England), May 26th. Now, are you aware that May 26th is also our feast day—the Feast of St. Philip, Apostle of Rome? Again, I see the anniversary of your foundation is set down as May 12th. But this is a great day with St. Philip and his Roman house, as being the festival of the Oratory Saints, SS. Nereus and Achilleus, whose church was the titular of the celebrated Oratorian Cardinal Baronius, the ecclesiastical historian, and one of the earliest disciples of St. Philip. Short as your address is, it contains in its compass what has required from me many words duly to answer. Moreover you have given me much more than an address, by coming with it yourselves, and letting us meet face to face. I have to thank you, then, for a visit,

as well as a beautifully embellished letter. For all this kindness I thank you from my heart again and again.

What a Cardinal ought to be

On August 15th, 1879, a deputation, amongst whom were Lord Ripon, Lord O'Hagan, and Sir Charles Clifford, presented an address of congratulation which was read by the Duke of Norfolk.

CARDINAL NEWMAN, in accepting the address, said: My Lords, Gentlemen, and my dear Friends,—Next to my promotion, by the wonderful condescension of the Holy Father, to a seat in the Sacred College, I cannot receive a greater honour than on the occasion of it to be congratulated as I now have been, by gentlemen who are not only of the highest social and personal importance, viewed in themselves, but who come to me as, in some sort, representatives of the Catholics of these islands—nay, of the wide British Empire. Nor do you come to me merely on occasion of my elevation, but with the purpose, or at least with the effect of co-operating with His Holiness in his act of grace towards me, and to make it less out of keeping in the imagination of the outer world with the course and circumstances of my life hitherto, and the associations attendant upon it. In this respect I conceive your address to have a meaning and an impressiveness of its own, distinct from those other congratulations more private, most touching, and most welcome, that have been made; and it is thus that I explain to myself the strength of your language about me as it occurs in the course of it. For, used though it be in perfect sincerity and simple affection, I never will believe that such a glowing panegyric as you have bestowed upon me was written for my own sake only, and not rather intended as an expression of the mind of English-speaking Catholics, and as a support thereby to me in my new dignity, which is really as necessary for me, though in a different way, as those contributions of material help with which also you are so liberally supplying me. I accept, then, your word and your deed as acts of loyalty and devotion to the Holy Father himself, and I return you thanks in, I may say, his name for your munificence to and your eloquent praise of me. Among the obligations of a Cardinal, I am pledged never to let my high dignity suffer in the eyes of men by fault of mine—never to forget what I have been made, and whom I represent; and if there is a man who more requires the support of others in satisfying the duties for which he was not born and in making himself more than himself, surely it is I. The Holy Father, the Hierarchy, the whole of Catholic Christendom, form not only a spiritual, but a visible body, and, as being a visible, they are necessarily a political body. They become, and were meant to become, a temporal polity, and that temporal aspect of the Church is brought out most prominently and impressively, and claims and commands the attention of the world most forcibly in the Pope, and in his court, and in his basilicas, palaces, and other establishments at Rome. It is an aspect rich in pomp and circumstance, in solemn ceremony, and in observances sacred from an antiquity beyond memory. He himself can only be in one place; the Cardinals, so far as he does not require their presence around him, represent him in all parts of the civilised world, and carry with them great historical associations, and are a living memento of the Church's unity, such as has no parallel in any other polity. They are the Princes of the Œcumenical Empire. The great prophecies in behalf of the Church are in them strikingly fulfilled, that "the Lord's house should be exalted above all the hills"; and that "Instead of thy fathers, sons are born to thee, whom thou shalt make princes over all the earth." I am not speaking of temporal domination, but of temporal pre-eminence and authority, of a moral and social power of a visible grandeur which even those who do not acknowledge it feel and bow before. You, my dear friends, have understood this; you have understood better than I what a Cardinal ought to be, and what I am not, the greatness of my position, and my wants. You

understood, and have, in St. Paul's words, "glorified my face." You are enabling me to bear a noble burden nobly. I trust I may never disappoint you or forfeit your sympathy, but as long as life lasts may be faithful to the new duties, which, by a surprising dispensation of Providence, have been suddenly allotted to me.

The Cardinal and the Club

On behalf of St. George's Club, Mr. Clifford read an address, August, 1879.

CARDINAL NEWMAN, in reply, said: When my first surprise was over, at the Sovereign Pontiff's gracious act towards me during the last spring, I felt that so great a gratification I could not have again as that signal recognition by the highest of earthly authorities, of my person, my past life, my doings in it, and their results. But close upon it, and next to it in moment and in claim upon my gratitude, come the wonderful sympathy and interest in me, so wide and so eager in their expression, with which that favour from His Holiness has been caught up by the general public and welcomed as appropriate on the part of friends and strangers to me, of those who have no liking for the objects for which I have worked as well as of those who have. In that accord and volume of kind and generous voices, you, Gentlemen, by the address which now has been presented to me, have taken a substantial part, and, thereby, would have a claim on me, though there were nothing else to give you a place in my friendly thoughts; but this is not all which gives a character of its own to your congratulations. I was much touched by your noticing the special tie of a personal character which attaches some of your members to me, and me to them; it is very kind in you to tell me of this, and it is a kindness which I shall not forget. Also there is between you and me a tie which is common to you all; and that, if not a religious tie also, at least an ecclesiastical one, and one which in more than one respect associates us together. St. George is your patron, and you are doubly under his patronage; first, because he is this country's Saint, and next in that voluntary union by virtue of which you address me. Now I, on the other side, have been appointed titular of his ancient church at Rome; his Chapter, his dependents, his fabric are all under my care; and here again, as I claim to have in you an interest more than others have, so you may claim to share in the devotion paid to that glorious Martyr in his venerable Basilica. But it would be wrong to detain you longer; and while I repeat my thanks to all the members of the Club for their address, my special thanks are due to you, Gentlemen, who have taken the trouble to present it to me in person.

On his standing as an Author

Mr. Edward Lucas presented an address from the Academia, signed by the Cardinal Archbishop of Westminster, August 15th, 1879.

IN reply Cardinal NEWMAN said: I offer my best thanks to the members of the Academia for the honour and the kindness they have done me by the address which has now been presented to me, and for the warmth of language with which their congratulations have been expressed. Also, I feel much gratified by their high estimate of the value of what I have written, of its literary merits, and of the service it has rendered to the interests of religion. Such praise comes with especial force and effect from the members of an Academia; for such a body, whatever be its particular scope and subject matter, still is ever, I conceive, in name and in office a literary, or, at least, an intellectual body; and, therefore, I naturally feel it as a high compliment to me that my various writings should receive the approbation of men whose very function, as belonging to it, is to be critical. However, I do not, I must not, forget that whatever presents itself for critical examination admits of being regarded under distinct, nay, contrary, aspects; and while I welcome your account of me as

expressive of your good-will and true respect for me, which claims my best acknowledgments, I shrink from taking it as representative of the judgment of the world about me, or of its intellectual circles either, and for this plain reason, because even I myself, who am not likely to be unjust to myself, have ever seen myself in colours less favourable to my self-love, to my powers, and to my works, than those in which you have arrayed me; hence I cannot allow myself to bask pleasantly in the sunshine of your praises, lest I lose something of that sobriety and balance of mind which it is a first duty jealously to maintain. In fact, the point on which you are so good as to insist upon, as if in my favour, has always been a sore point with me, and has suggested uncomfortable thoughts. A man must be very much out of the common to deserve the great names with which you honour me; and for myself, certainly, when I have reflected from time to time on the fact of the variety of subjects on which I have written, it has commonly been whispered in my ear, "To be various is to be superficial." I have not, indeed, blamed myself for a variety of work, which could not be avoided; I have written according to occasion, when there was a call on me to write; seldom have I written without call, but I have ever felt it to be an unpleasant necessity, and I have envied those who have been able to take and prosecute one line of research, one study, one science, as so many have done in this day, and thus to aspire to the *exegi monumentum* of the poet. I am not touching on the opinions which had characterised their labours, whether true or false. But I mean that an author feels his work to be more conscientious, satisfactory, and sound, when it is limited to one subject, when he knows all that can be known upon it, and when it is so fixed in his memory, and his possession of it is so well about him, that he is never at a loss when asked a question, and can give his answer at a minute's warning. But I must come to an end; and in ending, I hope you will not understand these last remarks to argue insensibility to the depth of interest in me and kindly sympathy with me in your address, which it would be very difficult, indeed, to overlook, but to me it is most difficult duly to respond.

To the Sisters of Notre Dame

The Marquis of Ripon presented an address from the Girls' Training college, Mount Pleasant, Liverpool, August 15th, 1879.

THE CARDINAL, in reply, said: The name of the Liverpool Sisters of Notre Dame would have been quite enough, without other words, to make me understand the value of the congratulations which your Lordship has been so good as to put into my hands in their behalf, and which, I need scarcely say, are rendered doubly welcome to me as coming to me through your Lordship. May I beg of you the additional favour of your assuring them in turn of the great pleasure which their address has given me, not only as proceeding from a Religious Community, whose kindly estimation of such as me is ever coincident or even synonymous with prayer for his welfare, but also as expressing the sentiments of ladies who, by their special culture of mind and educational experience, have a claim to be heard when they speak, as in this case, on a question whether his writings have done good service in the cause of Catholic faith. For the gratification, then, which their language concerning me has given me, and especially for that overflowing personal good-will towards me which in the first instance has led to their addressing me, I beg of your Lordship's kindness to return to them my most sincere acknowledgments.

On some matters of Education

The Marquis of Ripon, as Chairman of the Poor School Committee, read another address on the same occasion.

CARDINAL NEWMAN, in reply, said: My dear Friends, in returning to you my warmest and most hearty thanks for an address conceived in the language of personal friendship rather than a formal tender of congratulations on my recent elevation, I must express my especial pleasure on finding that the main view of my life which you select for notice is just that which I should wish you to fix upon, and should wish it for the same reason as has actuated you in selecting it—namely, because it brings you and myself together as associates in a common cause—the cause of education. To be honest, I do not deny that I could have wished you in some things which you have said of me to have less indulged your affectionate regard for me (I must venture on this phrase), and to have been more measured in language, which cannot indeed pain me because it is so genuine and earnest; but I prefer to dwell on that portion of your address which leads me to feel the pride and joy of fellowship with you in a great work, and lets me, with a safe conscience, allow you to speak well of me, nay, even lets me open my own mind and indirectly heighten your praise of me. It is indeed a satisfaction to me to believe that in my time, with whatever shortcomings, I have done something for the great work of education; and it is a second satisfaction that, whereas the cause of education has so long ago brought you into one body, you, whose interest in it is sure to have kept your eyes open to its fortunes, are able, after all disappointments, to pronounce, at the end of many years, that my endeavours have, in your judgment, had their measure of success. The Committee for the Poor Schools has existed now for thirty-two years, and two-thirds of its members are laymen. I, too, long before I was a Catholic priest, set myself to the work of making as the school so also the lecture-room Christian, and that work engages me still. I have ever joined together faith and knowledge, and considered engagements in educational work a special pastoral office. Thus, without knowing you, and without your religious advantages, I have in spirit and in fact ever associated myself with you. When I was public tutor of my College at Oxford, I maintained even fiercely that my employment was distinctly pastoral. I considered that, by the statutes of the University, a tutor's profession was of a religious nature. I never would allow that, in teaching the classics, I was absolved from carrying on, by means of them, in the minds of my pupils an ethical training. I considered a College tutor to have the care of souls, and before I accepted the office, I wrote down a private memorandum, that, supposing I could not carry out this view of it, the question would arise whether I could continue to hold it. To this principle I have been faithful throughout my life. It has been my defence to myself, since my ordination to the priesthood, for not having given myself to direct parochial duties, and for having allowed myself in a wide range of secular reading and thought, and of literary work. And now, at the end of my time, it is a consolation to me to be able to hope, if I dare rely upon results, that I have not been mistaken. I trust that I may, without presumption or arrogance, accept this surprising act of the Sovereign Pontiff towards me, and the general gratification which has followed upon it, as a favour given me from above. His Holiness, when he first told me what was in prospect for me, sent me word that he meant this honour to be “a public and solemn testimony” of his approbation; also that he gave it in order to give pleasure to Catholics and to my countrymen. Is not this a recognition of my past life almost too great for a man, and suggesting to him the *Nunc Dimittis* of the aged Saint? Only do you pray for me, my dear friends, that, by having a reward here, I may not lose the better one hereafter.

About the Benedictines

In reply to an address presented to him at the Birmingham Oratory, on September 18th, 1879, from the congregation of English Benedictines,

THE CARDINAL said: My dear Right Reverend and Very Reverend and Reverend Fathers,—I thought it a high honour, as indeed it was, to have received, in the course of the last six months, on the occasion of the Sovereign Pontiff's goodness to me, congratulations from several Benedictine houses; but now I am called upon to give expression to my still warmer and deeper gratitude for so formal and public an act of friendship, on my behalf, as comes to me today from the whole English Benedictine Congregation—a kindness done to me by the President-General in person, in company with other Abbots and high officials of the English body, and that with the express intention of preserving the memory and the interest they have taken in me, for later times. This, indeed, is a kindness which claims my heartfelt thanks, and it is the more gratifying to me, my dear Fathers, because, over and above the circumstances by which you have so studiously given emphasis to your act, it comes from Benedictines. The Holy Church at all times, early and late, is fair and gracious, replete with winning beauty and transcendent majesty: and one time cannot be pronounced more excellent than another; but I from a boy have been drawn in my affections to her first age beyond other ages, and to the monastic rule as it was then exemplified; and how was it possible to drink in the spirit of early Christianity, and to be enamoured of its loveliness, and to sit at the feet of the Saints, Anthony, Basil, Martin, Jerome, Paulinus, Augustine, and others, without a special sensibility and attraction to the grandeur of St. Benedict, who completes the list of ancient monastic Saints, or without a devout attachment to his multitudinous family? And when I became a Catholic, and found myself a son and servant of St. Philip, I rejoiced to think how much there was in the substance and spirit of his Institute like that which I had attributed to the primitive monks. His children, indeed, have no place in the pages of ecclesiastical history. We have not poured ourselves over Christendom century after century; have not withstood a flood of barbarism, and, after its calamities, “renewed the face of the earth;” we take up no great room in libraries, nor live in biographies and in the minds and hearts of spiritual men; but, as children of a Saint, we cannot but have a character of our own and a holy vocation; and, viewing it in itself, we may without blame ascribe to it a likeness to a Benedictine life, and claim a brotherhood with that old Benedictine world; in the spirit of Cardinal Baronius, one of St. Philip's first disciples, who tells us in his “Annals,” that by and in St. Philip's rule a beautiful apostolic method of spiritual life was renewed, and primitive times came back again. There are none, then, whose praise is more welcome to me than that of Benedictines; but it need scarcely be said, my dear Fathers, that to have a vivid admiration of a rule of life is not the same thing as to exemplify it. I know myself better than you do; you think far too well of me, and I beg your good prayers that I may be more like that ideal of work and prayer which in your charitableness you identify with me.

Asking, “If this is Coldness, What is Warmth?”

In reply to an address presented by the Earl of Denbigh, on behalf of the Diocese of Birmingham, THE CARDINAL said: My dear Friends,—Your most welcome address brings before me the memories of many past years. The greater part of my life—that is, more than half of the long interval since I was a schoolboy—has been spent here, and the words which you use about it come home to me with the force of both a surprise and a pleasure which I had thought no speakers or writers could excite but such as had the same vivid experience of those eventful years as I have myself. You are not so old as I am. How is it, then, that you recollect my past so well? Every

year brings its eventful changes—some entering, others leaving, this perishable scene. Yet so it is that by the favour of good Providence I have lost old friends only to gain new ones, and the ever-fresh generation of Catholics—clerical and lay—attached to this see seems as ever handing down a tradition of what happened to me years before itself; a tradition always kind, nay, I may say always affectionate to me. Of course, I view that past under a different aspect from yours. To me it is filled up with memorials of special kindnesses and honours which you have done to me, more than I can recount or represent in these few sentences. I recollect, for instance, thirty-six years ago, with what kind anxiety Dr. Wiseman, then Coadjutor-Bishop, exerted himself when I was living near Oxford to bring me within the safe lines of Holy Church, and how, when I had been received by Father Dominic, of the Congregation of the Passion, I at once found myself welcomed and housed at Oscott—the whole College boys, I may say, as well as the authorities of the place, receiving me with open arms, till I was near forgetting that I must not encroach on their large hospitality. How many kind and eager faces, young and old, come before me now as they passed along the corridors or took part in the festivities of St. Cecilia's Day, or assisted at more directly sacred commemorations, during the first months that I was a Catholic, and afterwards when Dr. Wiseman had called us from Oxford to be near him. The first act of the Bishop of the diocese, Dr. Walsh, was to give us Old Oscott, since called Maryvale, as our possession; a munificent act, which Pope Pius confirmed in his Brief, though we felt it a duty on our coming here to restore it to the diocese. And when we had come here, and our position was permanently fixed, the same kindness was shown to me as before, and especially by our present venerated Bishop. What are those instances which you mention of my preaching at St. Chad's on his Lordship's installation, and on other special occasions, but so many singular honours shown on my behalf? As years went on in a troublous time, and amid the conflict of opinion, there never was a misgiving about me in my own neighbourhood. I recollect with great gratitude the public meeting held by the Catholics of this place in acknowledgment of lectures which I had delivered during the excitement caused in the country by the establishment of the Hierarchy; and how, when those lectures involved me in serious legal difficulties soon afterwards, the Birmingham Catholics, and prominently some excellent laymen, whose memory is very dear to me, started and headed that general subscription to meet my expenses which reached so magnificent a sum. And again, years afterwards, when an affront offered to me had involved an affront to the whole Catholic priesthood, and I on both accounts had felt bound to take notice of it, I was, amid my anxieties, cheered and rewarded by an address of thanks from the clergy assembled in Diocesan Synod, as is kept in continual memory by the autographs on the walls of our guest-room of the kind priests who did me this honour. Nor was the Bishop wanting to this great acknowledgment; he gave it a sanction as precious as it was rare, by proposing that each of the priests of his diocese should, in connexion with the subject of their address, say Mass for me. And now, after all this, you crown your kindness when my course is all but run, by resolving that the Holy Father shall not raise me to the Sacred College without, by your cordial congratulation, having a share in his act of grace. What am I to say to all this? It has been put about by those who were not Catholics that as a convert I have been received coldly by the Catholic body; and if it is coldness, I wonder what warmth is. One thought more comes into my mind, and with it I will conclude. I have many times felt sorely what poor services I have rendered to you to gain such recompenses as I have been recounting. It is very plain that I have had the wages of a public life with the freedom and comfort of a private one. You have let me go my own way, and have never been hard upon me. Following the lead of the good Bishop, you, in all your communications with me, have made allowances for our rule, for my health and strength, for my

age, for my habits and peculiarities, and have ever been delicate, ever acted tenderly towards me. May the Almighty God return to his Lordship, and to all of you, a hundredfold that mercy and that loving sympathy which he and you have shown so long to me.

On Affairs of Ireland

In reply to an address of congratulation on his elevation to the Sacred College, read by Lord O'Hagan, in 1880, "on behalf of the Catholics of Ireland,"

HIS EMINENCE said: My Lord O'Hagan, I should be strangely constituted if I were not deeply moved by the address which your Lordship has done me the honour of presenting to me on the occasion of my elevation, by the grace of the Sovereign Pontiff, to a seat in the Sacred College. It almost bewilders me to receive an expression so warm, so special, so thorough, from men so high in station, ecclesiastical and civil—speaking too, as they avow, in behalf of a whole Catholic people; and, in order to this, giving themselves the inconvenience and fatigue of a long journey in the midst of their serious occupations. But while I reply to their commendation of me with somewhat of shame from the consciousness how much more I might have done in life than I have done, and how much better, still my reverence for them obliges me to submit myself to their praise as a grave and emphatic judgment upon me, which it would be rude to question, and unthankful not to be proud of, and impossible ever to forget. But their address is not only an expression of their praise, it also conveys to me from Ireland a message of attachment. It is a renewal and enlargement of a singular kindness done to me a year ago, and even then not for the first time. I have long known what good friends I have in Ireland; they in their affection have taken care that I should know it, and the knowledge has been at times a great support to me. They have not been of those who trust a man one day and forget him the next; and though I have not much to boast of in most points of view, I will dare to say that if, on my appointment to a high post in Ireland, I came there with the simple desire and aim to serve a noble people who I felt had a great future, deeply sensible of the trust, but otherwise, I may say, without thought of myself—if this creates a claim upon your remembrance, I can, with a good conscience, accept it. And here I am led on to refer to a special circumstance, on which you touch with much delicacy and sympathy, and which I can hardly avoid since you mention it, namely, the accident that in past years I have not always been understood, or had justice done to my real sentiments and intentions in influential quarters at home and abroad. I will not deny that on several occasions this has been my trial, and I say this without assuming that I had no blame myself in its coming upon me. But, then, I reflected that whatever pain that trial might cost me, it was the lightest that I could have; that a man was not worth much who could not bear it; that, if I had not this, I might have a greater; that I was conscious to myself of a firm faith in the Catholic Church, and of loyalty to the Holy See; that I was, and had been, blessed with a fair measure of success in my work; and that prejudice and misconception did not last for ever. And now my wonder is, as I feel it, that the sunshine has come out so soon, and with so fair a promise of lasting through my evening. My Lord and Gentlemen, in speaking so much of myself, I feel I must be trying your patience; but you have led me on to be familiar with you. I will say no more than offer a prayer to the Author of All Good, that the best blessings may descend from Him on all those who have taken part in this gracious act exercised towards one who has so faint a claim on their generosity.

In reply to another address from Ireland presented by the Bishop of Ardagh at the Birmingham Oratory, on behalf of the Catholic University of Ireland, His Eminence made the following reply in writing to the Rector and Senate of the University:

MY DEAR FRIENDS,—This is not the first time that I have had the gratification of receiving from you a public expression of your attachment to me, and of your generous good opinion of my exertions in behalf of the University. Many years have passed since then; and now I receive your welcome praise a second time, together with the additional gratification that it is the second. And I notice further, with great gratitude, that whereas in most cases the sentiments which lead to such an act of kindness become, as time goes on, less lively than they were at first, you, on the contrary, use even stronger and warmer language about me now than that which cheered and gladdened me so much, and was so great a compensation of my anxieties in 1858. And there is still another pleasure which your address has given me. Of course, a lapse of time so considerable has brought with it various changes in the constituent members, in the ruling and teaching body of the University. I consider it, then, to be a singular favour conferred upon me that those whom I have not the advantage of knowing personally should join in this gracious act with those who are my old friends. No earthly satisfaction is without its drawbacks, and my last remark naturally leads me on to one sad thought, which you yourselves towards the end of your address have suggested. A great Prelate has been lately taken from us, to whose simple faith and noble constancy in the cause of the University it is owing that the University maintains its place amid the many obstacles by which its progress has been beset. I ever had the greatest, the truest reverence for the good Cardinal Cullen. I used to say of him that his countenance had a light upon it which made me feel as if, during his many years at Rome, all the Saints of the Holy City had been looking into it, and he into theirs. And I have cause to know from the mouth of Pope Pius himself, that on a very critical occasion he promptly, emphatically, and successfully stood my friend. That was in the year 1867. How sincere would have been his congratulations to me at this time! I am deprived of them; but by thus expressing my sense of my loss I best relieve myself of the pain of it. I cannot bring these acknowledgments to an end without tendering in turn my congratulations to you, that the serious loss which you have lately sustained by the elevation to the Episcopate of my dear friend your Rector ², who has laboured for the University so long and with such devotion, has been so happily repaired by the appointment in his place of an ecclesiastic whose antecedents are a guarantee for its prosperous advance in that enlarged field which is now opened to its activity and its usefulness. And now, thanking you from a full heart for your indulgence and abundant kindness towards me, I will make no further claim upon your time.

On Young Australia and Old England

On behalf of the Catholics of Australia, led by the Right Hon. W. Bede Dalley, a gold salver was presented to His Eminence by the Duke of Norfolk, at a meeting in Willis's Rooms, May, 1880.

HIS EMINENCE, acknowledging the gift, said: It has been a great and a most welcome surprise to me to find that I, dwelling in England, should have succeeded in gaining friends at the other side of the earth—friends so many and so warm, friends whom I seem to myself to have done so little to deserve, yet who have been so resolute in making known both their warmth and their numbers to the world at large. Besides the address, which high and low have with such wonderful unanimity joined in sending to me, they have made me a beautiful and costly and singularly artistic present, which speaks of their country, by virtue of the rich indigenous material of which it consists,

²Even the *Times*, commenting upon this address, said: "The truth of much in Cardinal Newman's explanation of the amended relations between English Protestants and English Roman Catholics cannot be denied. No Englishman would wish to deny it. It must be acknowledged, also, that Protestants confronted with Catholics in the communication of daily life were unable to continue to think the religion they professed immoral and debasing."

and of their kind hearts in the flattering and touching words which are engraven upon it. And that these words may be the more grateful to me, the donors have been at pains to gain in the choice of them the aid of a well-known and highly distinguished scholar, who had known me years ago when he was an inhabitant of the great metropolitan centre in which my lot is cast. I must make a further remark. It is well known that in conferring on me my high dignity, the Sovereign Pontiff, in consideration of my age and delicate health, suspended in my case the ordinary rule, and condescended to allow me, by a rare privilege, to remain, though a Cardinal of the Holy Roman Church, in my own country, nay, in my own place in the Oratory; and this being so, I notice it as a happy coincidence that, as if in anticipation of his Holiness's indulgence to me, his Australian children have engraven on their gift—with a true instinct of what would please me as regards it, in looking on to the time when others must be owners of it—not only my own name, but the names of those Fathers whom, by search into one of my publications, they found to have been for so many years my intimate friends and brothers in the Oratory of Birmingham. There was just one other act of kindness open to them, and they have not let it slip. When the time came for my receiving their gift, they did not choose that it should be presented to me by the mere mechanical appliances of the steam-vessel and the railway-van, but it is now placed in my hands by a great person, by one whom I have been allowed to know, love, and take an interest in even from his very childhood, whom the Catholics of England recognise as their hereditary chief, and whose participation in this act of grace associates in my honour the fresh life and bright future of Colonial England with the grand memories of the past and the romance of the mediæval period.

To Boys, about the Rosary

Preaching at Oscott College, on Sunday, October 5th, 1879, from the text "They found Mary and Joseph, and the Infant lying in a manger,"

THE CARDINAL said: I am not going to make a long address to you, my dear boys, or say anything that you have not often heard before from your superiors, for I know well in what good hands you are, and I know that their instructions come to you with greater force than any you can have from a stranger. If I speak to you at all, it is because I have lately come from the Holy Father, and am, in some sort, his representative, and so in the years to come you may remember that you saw me today and heard me speak in his name, and remember it to your profit. You know that today we keep the Feast of the Holy Rosary, and I propose to say to you what occurs to me on this great subject. You know how that devotion came about; how, at a time when heresy was very widespread, and had called in the aid of sophistry, that can so powerfully aid infidelity against religion, God inspired St. Dominic to institute and spread this devotion. It seems so simple and easy, but you know God chooses the small things of the world to humble the great. Of course it was first of all for the poor and simple, but not for them only, for everyone who has practised the devotion knows that there is in it a soothing sweetness that there is in nothing else. It is difficult to know God by our own power, because He is incomprehensible. He is invisible to begin with, and therefore incomprehensible. We can in some way know him, for even among the heathens there were some who had learned many truths about Him; but even they found it hard to conform their lives to their knowledge of Him. And so in His mercy He has given us a revelation of Himself by coming amongst us, to be one of ourselves, with all the relations and qualities of humanity, to gain us over. He came down from Heaven and dwelt amongst us, and died for us. All these things are in the Creed, which contains the chief things that He has revealed to us about Himself. Now the great power of the Rosary lies in this, that it makes the Creed into a prayer; of course, the

Creed is in some sense a prayer and a great act of homage to God; but the Rosary gives us the great truths of His life and death to meditate upon, and brings them nearer to our hearts. And so we contemplate all the great mysteries of His life and His birth in the manger; and so too the mysteries of His suffering and His glorified life. But even Christians, with all their knowledge of God, have usually more awe than love of Him, and the special virtue of the Rosary lies in the special way in which it looks at these mysteries; for with all our thoughts of Him are mingled thoughts of His Mother, and in the relations between Mother and Son we have set before us the Holy Family, the home in which God lived. Now the family is, even humanly considered, a sacred thing; how much more the family bound together by supernatural ties, and, above all, that in which God dwelt with His Blessed Mother. This is what I should most wish you to remember in future years. For you will all of you have to go out into the world, and going out into the world means leaving home; and, my dear boys, you don't know what the world is now. You look forward to the time when you will go out into the world, and it seems to you very bright and full of promise. It is not wrong for you to look forward to that time; but most men who know the world find it a world of great trouble, and disappointments, and even misery. If it turns out so to you, seek a home in the Holy Family that you think about in the mysteries of the Rosary. Schoolboys know the difference between school and home. You often hear grown-up people say that the happiest time of their life was that passed at school; but when they were at school you know they had a happier time, which was when they went home; that shows there is a good in home which cannot be found elsewhere. So that even if the world should actually prove to be all that you now fancy it, if it should bring you all that you could wish, yet you ought to have in the Holy Family a home with a holiness and sweetness about it that cannot be found elsewhere. This is, my dear boys, what I most earnestly ask you. I ask you when you go out into the world, as you soon must, to make the Holy Family your home, to which you may turn from all the sorrow and care of the world and find a solace, a compensation, and a refuge. And this I say to you, not as if I should speak to you again, not as if I had of myself any claim upon you, but with the claims of the Holy Father, whose representative I am, and in the hope that in the days to come you will remember that I came amongst you and said it to you. And when I speak of the Holy Family I do not mean Our Lord and Our Lady only, but St. Joseph too; for as we cannot separate Our Lord from His Mother, so we cannot separate St. Joseph from them both; for who but he was their protector in all the scenes of Our Lord's early life? And with Joseph must be included St. Elizabeth and St. John, whom we naturally think of as part of the Holy Family; we read of them together and see them in pictures together. May you, my dear boys, throughout your life find a home in the Holy Family; the home of Our Lord and His Blessed Mother, St. Joseph, St. Elizabeth, and St. John.

On the Relations between Catholics and Protestants in England

At the Catholic Re-union held in Birmingham in January, 1880, Cardinal Newman presided, and delivered an address.

HIS EMINENCE said: It was natural, my dear friends, when I found myself honoured by your request to preside at this great annual meeting of Catholics, being aware that, according to custom, I should have to address them, that I should be anxious to find some subject which was both seasonable in itself and interesting to my hearers. But how could I hope to hit upon any topic which had not been anticipated by those who have preceded me in this chair? It has for more than twenty years been filled successively by men conspicuous in various lines of eminence—by great ecclesiastics, by noblemen and statesman, by men of high position and distinguished name,

by country gentlemen, by men of high talent or wide experience, who have made this one of the most remarkable Catholic gatherings in the country. And these former presidents have had the pick of all subjects, and the judgment and tact to select those which were most suitable to the occasion. The reflection came to me with great force, and I felt that it would serve as my apology if I failed in finding a subject equal to the duty which lay upon me. However, I am not so badly off as it may appear at first sight. The lapse of time is itself a subject, and I shall find one tonight far larger than I need—nay, one which rather is embarrassing from its very largeness, if I remind you of the circumstances under which you began these social meetings, and the great change which has taken place in our condition as Catholics since then. Not long before these annual gatherings commenced, and close upon thirty years ago, Catholics had suddenly become very unpopular both in Birmingham and through the whole country. I am not proposing to enter into the history of an unhappy time. The misfortune to us arose from a singular misunderstanding, which Catholics would have hindered by anticipation could they have conjectured that it would take place. It was generally fancied that in some way or other our authorities at Rome were conspiring together against the religious liberties of England; and that, by appointing an English Cardinal and English Bishops, they intended or hoped, in some unjustifiable way or other to propagate in this country the Catholic religion. It was thought also to be a great insult to the religion of the country not to recognise that there was established here already a Christian hierarchy, and that to set up another, as if in its stead, was a great offence. And when the Government of the day, or at least some very distinguished statesman, took the same view, the excitement became extreme. We were thought very ill of, and very unmindful of the tolerance already extended to us; and then, as it will happen at such a time, all the old stories against us were brought out anew and put into circulation, and, as we have lasted 1,800 years and the Protestant sects around us only three hundred, it need not surprise anyone if more could be said by our enemies against us—truths or falsehoods, exaggerations or misstatements—than could be said against them even if we tried, especially since from our very greatness we have vastly more temptations and opportunities to act wrongly than they have had. And since (bad luck for us) we had never kept a register of Protestant scandals, as our enemies had kept of ours, and in consequence were in no condition to show that what there had been evil or faulty in times past in our body was to be laid to the charge, not of our religion, but of depraved human nature, we were at a great disadvantage; and even good and well-meaning Protestants got to entertain a bad opinion of us, and a great prejudice, distrust, and dislike of us was diffused through the country, and all animosity leading in many cases both to cruel and to violent acts. Things are very different now with us, and we have cause to be grateful to the inhabitants of this great town that so it is. Not that the ill opinion of those among whom one lives is the worst of trials. There are others far worse than it; bad words break no bones, and calumny is generally short-lived; but though popular disfavour, if it does not go further, is not an extraordinary trial, the good opinion of others—their respect, their good wishes, their sympathy, their kindness—is a very great pleasure, a very great gain; and therefore I think it quite a point to be remembered and recorded, a matter for congratulating each other upon and rejoicing in, so far as we have it. And certainly there is a very striking contrast in the sort of welcome given by Englishmen to the late Cardinal Wiseman when he came as Cardinal in Michaelmas, 1850, and their conduct towards us at the present time. The contrast is striking, and I may be allowed, perhaps, to set before you one or two causes of the change of which that contrast is the evidence; and in the remarks which I am about to make, and especially in any criticism I may incidentally pass on some acts of my countrymen, I hope I may say nothing which can be taken as inconsistent with the true affection and esteem I feel for

them, or with my gratitude to that great aggregate of ranks and classes which constitute what is called the public, from whom, though sometimes unfair to me, I have of late years, and now again recently, received such abundant marks of goodwill. First, the adverse sentiment was too violent, too unjust, sometimes too extravagant, to last. No wonder there was so widespread an alarm, and no wonder again it was of such short continuance, when we recollect what it was that was said about us. For instance, in a village which I happened to know, it had been prophesied even at an early date that if the Papists got the upper hand, the street of the village would flow with blood. A statement of a less prodigious character, but one far more cruel in its action on an unoffending and defenceless class, came from a high ecclesiastical quarter in the Establishment, and was to the effect that Protestant families would do well to be on their guard against Catholic servants, for these were spies on their masters and mistresses, and told all that happened indoors to their priest. Such extreme sayings—and they were not few—would necessarily lead to a reaction, and thereby do us a service, though not so intended; and, in fact, in a little time the public did begin to be ashamed of saying them and believing them. Englishmen are a kind-hearted people at bottom, when they have not gone mad, which, alas they do every now and then. Accordingly, in a little time, after passing an Act of Parliament against us, and against the Catholics of Ireland—who had nothing to do with the cause of the quarrel, for they had no need of a hierarchy of Bishops, having had one from time immemorial—after the Act of Parliament, I say, they felt a satisfaction and relief, and calmed down. And then a generous feeling came over them, that perhaps they had been hard upon us. This is the first cause how we come to be in happier relations with our countrymen now than we were thirty years ago. It is an instance of the operation of the psychological law that reaction of mind follows on great excitement. There was a second reason for a change, which followed close upon the first, and that was the experience which came to the nation, as time went on, that, after all, their alarm somehow had been unnecessary. Their Act of Parliament did not hinder our having diocesan Bishops and Chapters, Cardinals, and Orders of religious men. How could it? It could only hinder our using certain names, calling our Bishops Bishops, and carrying out the duties of our religion with certain solemnities. But Holy Church is intangible; nor could they touch her children, unless, indeed, they meant to proceed to actual persecution. This they did not dream of; and soon they made the second discovery that, as they could not touch us, neither could we touch them; that we and they belonged to different spheres of life, that their objects were secular and ours religious. I don't mean to say that there could not be usurpations on our side and on theirs; but, while what might be called a concordat was observed between temporals and spirituals, there might indeed be small collisions between the regal and pontifical. They might injure us indirectly, as by now and then troubling us by their legislation; and we might employ our civil rights in a way they did not like, in the interest of the rights of conscience, as other religious bodies do; but this was all. There was no reason for the grave prophecies of danger, and the panic fright, and the stringent measures on the part of the Executive and the country, of which we had been the subjects and the victims. We wished to live in peace with our countrymen, and there was no reason why they, too, should not be friendly, and cherish goodwill and act charitably towards us. As time went on this was felt more and more by candid minds; and even those who had been prejudiced against us began to see that there was no reason that the Church of Rome should not have clergy for its people in England any more than that the Protestant missionary bodies of England should refrain from sending their clergy and ministers to Africa or New Zealand, which is sometimes a great offence to the English Establishment in foreign parts, and causes great quarrels, as in Ceylon now. But you may say that in thus speaking I am not mending matters, because this was just one of our greatest offences in the

eyes of our countrymen thirty years ago, viz., the insult of proposing to convert Englishmen, as if they were heathen; and such intention was a great source of irritation. This was, I need hardly say, a great misunderstanding; and thus I am brought to what I consider to be a third and most remarkable instrument in the change of feeling in our favour which has taken place of late years among Protestants. That change has arisen in good part from that very consequence which they anticipated and so much dreaded, and which has actually taken place—the conversions—which have not been few. Of course it would be very absurd in us, and, I may say, very wicked, if we said that this was a heathen country, and needed conversion as a heathen country needs it. There is a widespread knowledge of Christianity among us, a love of the main truths, a zeal in their behalf, and an admirable prodigality, as I may call it, of contributions in furthering them. There are a great many religious, a great many actively benevolent men among Protestants. This is not inconsistent with our holding that they know only half the Gospel; and, as we are sure that we have the whole, not merely the half, this is a good reason why we should wish to make them Catholics, even though they be not heathen. We never conceal that we would make them Catholics if we could by fair and honest means. On the other hand, it is but natural that they should oppose us, be angry with us, and be afraid of us. True; but what I wish to show, and what I believe to be the remarkable fact, is that, whereas there have been many conversions to the Catholic Church during the last thirty years, and a great deal of ill-will has been felt towards us in consequence, nevertheless that ill-will has been overcome, and a feeling of positive goodwill has been created instead, in the minds of our very enemies, by means of those conversions, which they feared from their hatred of us; and I will say how. The Catholics in England fifty years ago were an unknown sect among us. Now there is hardly a family but has brothers, or sisters, or cousins, or connexions, or friends and acquaintances, or associates in business or work, of that religion, not to mention the large influx of population from the sister island; and such an interpenetration of Catholics with Protestants, especially in our great cities, could not take place without there being a gradual accumulation of experience, slow indeed, but therefore the more sure, about individual Catholics, and what they really are in character, and whether or not they can be trusted in the concerns and intercourse of life. And I fancy that Protestants, spontaneously and before setting about to form a judgment, have found them to be men whom they could be drawn to like and to love quite as much as their fellow Protestants might be—human beings whom they could be interested in and could sympathise with, and interchange good offices with, before the question of religion came into consideration. Perhaps they even got into intimacy and fellowship with some one of them before they knew he was a Catholic, for religious convictions in this day do not show themselves in a man's exterior; and then, when their minds turned back on their existing prejudices against the Catholic religion, it would be forced upon them that that hated creed, at least, had not destroyed what was estimable and agreeable in him, or at least that he was a being with human affections and human tastes, whatever might be his inner religious convictions. Perhaps the particular specimen of a Catholic which I have supposed might only go half way in possessing this sort of ethical appeal to the goodwill of others, or a quarter way, but he would have enough to destroy their imaginary notions of what a Catholic, and, much more, a priest, must be, and to make short work, and once for all, of that Guy Faux or Duke of Alva sort of Papist who hitherto stood in their minds for the normal representative of a Roman Catholic. I have been speaking of those ordinary and visible traits of character, of what is human merely, what is social in personal bearing, of what, as a moral magnetism, unites men to each other—of those qualities which are the basis, the *sine qua non* of a political community—of those qualities which may be expressed by the word “neighbourly;”

and I say that Catholics, as a body, are, to say the least, quite as neighbourly as Protestants, as attractive, as capable of uniting in civil society; and I say that in consequence, their multiplication in England, by making them visible, tangible, sensible, must, as an inevitable consequence, create a more kindly feeling to them than has existed hitherto; and it has done. I have not spoken of social virtues such as make a man respected and honoured, for that was not necessary for my purpose, though, whatever our failings may be as sons of Adam, I trust that at least we do not fall below that standard which is received in our country as the condition of a good name. And I might have enlarged on this—that, much as members of a Protestant country may dislike their relations being converted to a religion not their own, and angry as they may be with them at first, yet, as time goes on, they take their part when others speak against them, and anyhow feel the cruelty as well as the baseness of the slanders circulated against Catholics when those slanders include those dear to them; and they are indignant at the slanderer and feel tender towards the slandered from the very fact that among the subjects of such calumnious treatment are persons who, as their experience tells them, so little deserve it. And now, had time admitted, I might have gone on to other distinct causes of that change which I have taken for my subject; but, since this cannot be, I will content myself with referring to another kind of knowledge of Catholics which has operated in their favour—a knowledge not to any great extent experimental and personal, but public, coming to the population at large from special witnesses—perhaps few and only on special occasions—and by means of the periodical press, and the trustworthy informants, of whose testimony it is the vehicle. And as an instance of what I mean, I will notice the great figure presented in this way to the whole world by the late Pope Pius IX., and its effects in favour of Catholics. This, surely, is a fair and striking instance of knowledge of Catholics, telling in their favour. If there is any representative of the Roman Church from whom Protestants ought to shrink, it is her head. In their theory, in their controversial publications, in their traditions, the Pope is all that is bad. You know the atrocious name they give him: he is the embodiment of evil, and the worst foe of the Gospel. Then, as to Pope Pius, no one could, both by his words and by deeds, offend them more. He claimed, he exercised larger powers than any other Pope ever did; he committed himself to ecclesiastical acts bolder than those of any other Pope; his secular policy was especially distasteful to Englishmen; he had some near him who put into print just that kind of gossip concerning him which put an Englishman's teeth on edge; lastly, he it was who, in the beginning of his reign, was the author of that very measure which raised such a commotion among us; yet his personal presence was of a kind which no one could withstand. I believe one special cause of the abatement of the animosity felt towards us by our countrymen was the series of tableaux, as I may call them, brought before them in the newspapers of his reception of visitors in the Vatican. His misfortunes, indeed, had something to do with his popularity. The whole world felt that he was shamefully used as regards his temporal possessions. No foreign power had a right to seize upon his palaces, churches, and other possessions; and the injustice shown him created a wide interest in him; but the main cause of his popularity was the magic of his presence, which was such as to dissipate and utterly destroy the fog out of which the image of a Pope looms to the ordinary Englishman. His uncompromising faith, his courage, the graceful intermingling in him of the human and the divine, the humour, the wit, the playfulness with which he tempered his severity, his naturalness, and then his true eloquence, and the resources he had at command for meeting with appropriate words the circumstances of the moment, overcame those who were least likely to be overcome. A friend of mine, a Protestant, a man of practised intellect and mature mind, told me, to my surprise, that at one of the Pope's receptions at the Vatican he was so touched by the discourse made by His Holiness to his visitors

that he burst into tears. And this was the experience of hundreds. How could they think ill of him or of his children when his very look and voice were so ethical, so eloquent, so persuasive? Yet, I believe, wonderful as was the mode and the effect with which Pius preached our holy religion, we have not lost by his being taken away. It is not decorous to praise the living, it is not modest to panegyriser those whom rather one should obey; but in the successor of Pius, I recognise a depth of thought, a tenderness of heart, a winning simplicity, a power answering to his name which keeps me from lamenting that Pope Pius is no longer here. But I must cut short what has been already too long, though I have not reached the end. I will only say, in conclusion, that, though Englishmen are much more friendly to us as individuals, I see nothing to make me think that they are more friendly to our religion. They do not, indeed, believe, as they once believed, that our religion is so irrational that a man who professes it must be wanting either in honesty or in wit; but this is not much to grant, for the great question remains to decide whether it is possible for a country to continue any long time in the unnatural position of thinking ill of a religion and thinking well of believers in it. One would expect that either dislike of the religion would create an unfriendly feeling towards its followers, or friendliness towards its followers would ensure goodwill towards the religion. How this problem will be solved is one of the secrets of the future³.

In response to a vote of thanks proposed by Bishop Ilsley, and seconded by the Earl of Gainsborough,

HIS EMINENCE said if he were to speak till tomorrow he could not say one thousandth part of what he felt at their kindness and at the honour which had been conferred upon him. He felt the great and enormous kindness that had been shown to him, and it was a great surprise to him as well as a blessing, that he should have been so honoured with the Pope's recognition. He never felt in his life, nor did he now feel, that he deserved such an honour. At the same time he could not help feeling very pleased as well as grateful for it. From his heart he returned them his thanks.

In an Oxford Pulpit again

On Saturday, May 22nd, 1880, Cardinal Newman arrived at Oxford about five o'clock in the afternoon, and proceeded to Trinity college, where he had been made an Honorary Fellow two years earlier, and where he was cordially welcomed as a guest. His Eminence, having been entertained at dinner by the President and Fellow's of Trinity, attended the College "gaudy" in the evening, at which there was a large and distinguished company, the conversazione taking place in the college gardens, which were illuminated by limelight. The Cardinal, whose voice had not been heard from any pulpit in Oxford since his secession from the Church of England, preached on Sunday in the then new Church of St. Aloysius, both in the morning and in the evening, to crowded congregations. In the morning,

HIS EMINENCE said that during the last half-year they had been engaged in tracing out the first steps of Our Lord's coming on earth. They began with Advent, and it might be said that they began with November, because, November being the month given to the memory of the dead, they were reminded of the cause of the death of the Son from which a series of doctrines began. They started from Advent; firstly, they adverted to Our Lord's coming upon earth, to His incarnation, His taking the flesh, and then they went on to trace Him into the wilderness, and the wonderful

³Even the *Times*, commenting upon this address, said: "The truth of much in Cardinal Newman's explanation of the amended relations between English Protestants and English Roman Catholics cannot be denied. No Englishman would wish to deny it. It must be acknowledged, also, that Protestants confronted with Catholics in the communication of daily life were unable to continue to think the religion they professed immoral and debasing."

truths that were taught concerning Him were commemorated. So they were led on through His history to His resurrection, to His ascension, and then to the coming of the Holy Ghost. They were led on to contemplate the facts and details of those great events. They began naturally and suitably with tracing Almighty God Himself, who was indeed their Lord. To Him they came Who was the beginning and the end. Such was the course of the half-year which was full of change. It was the ruling of the economy of the Son of God upon earth, and the other half of the year was a time of rest and peace and contemplation, and, looking upon this part and that part in detail, they could see all the great things which He had done for them. They commemorated the most glorious mystery and the most joyous mystery. They commemorated what they did not understand, but what they understood sufficiently well to be thankful for. It was a mystery which must ever be before them, which they ever enjoyed, and which they could never understand here. And not even in Heaven, for Almighty God alone understood Himself. Sometimes the great mystery was compared, and with great reason, to the sun in this physical world. The sun, they knew, was the cause of all good to them; the sun was the source of heat, light, and growth, and of all they were in a certain sense. They could not look at it. If they attempted to look at it they were blinded, and so it was in respect to that great mystery of the Holy Trinity in Unity. They could take it as presented to them. If they attempted to decide upon the point; if they attempted by their own skill and wit to come to a conclusion about it, other or beyond what Almighty God had told them by Revelation, they were as if they blinded themselves. That blindness was what they meant by heresy. They attempted to do that which they could not do. They knew that certain great truths were told them by that mystery. They must take them and use them, but if they attempted to compare them, and so to unite them into one another, or to add anything more than what the Church had done, or what had been done for them by the Apostles themselves, more than what was put into them, or had grown up in such fulness in the past, then they in fact blinded themselves, and their faith became heresy. They blinded themselves because they attempted what was beyond human reason. Such was the heresy of Arius. There were certain truths, and he wished to unite them in his own way; whereas the great defence of the Catholic faith was that they did not understand it, but they must take what was given them. If they looked into what was told them they found certain great characteristics. To those who took it as the Church's truth it was perfectly intelligible for all practical or devotional purposes for which it was given them, but if they attempted to go beyond that they failed. God had given them certain truths which were useful and needful, but which could not be compared. One of the first duties of the Church was when a man became a Catholic to put that truth among other truths before him, and it was most irrational in him to become a Catholic and not accept it. He must take the truth as it was given. Those who were familiar with Greek and Latin knew that there were modes of expression for which they had no English, and therefore he could not use the words which were there used. They were accustomed to use the words of Him Who bore witness that there were in Heaven the Father, the Son, and the Holy Ghost; and they believed that the Father was God, and that was intelligible enough. Anyone who believed in a God could on that account fully understand those words. The Father was God—the poorest, the least educated, the dullest, could take in the truth that the Father was God, and could point out and contemplate what was told him. That the Son was God was perfectly intelligible. All Catholics, not to say any others, knew what it was to believe in the Son of God, and to obey Him; and, then, again, to say, thirdly, the Holy Ghost was God, and to worship Him as such, was perfectly intelligible, and they had no difficulty in believing it. In these propositions there were no difficulties. It was only when they compared them together one with the other, when they wanted to know how this was true,

and how the other two were true too, that there was a difficulty. When men wanted to try and find out something which would make it simpler they drifted into error, commonly called heresy, as against the words given them from the beginning. So also they could see how it was—that it was quite as clear why those great truths, those mysteries, were given them. It would be impossible for them to understand what was told them about an Infinite Being without a certain knowledge. They must partly comprehend what they were led to. They could not do more than to submit in the nature of things. They would recollect that they were speaking of an Infinite Almighty God, and how could they reason about infinities? Directly they began to attempt it they found out how insurmountable it was. Their only resource was to take what was given them, and then there was no difficulty in believing what clearly from the nature of things was above them. But if he were asked why it was that God in His mercy—in His great love for them—had told them so much, he could but answer that it was cruelly ungrateful in those who believed that He had spoken to refuse to accept it. The difficulty was that Almighty God should not have spoken to the whole world. After He had spoken to them it had been as well that, for a time, great parts of the world should be in darkness, but if He could be with them He must tell them something of Himself. How could He come to them in the way of knowledge except He did so in their way? Supposing God withheld Himself from them; supposing He left them when they departed this life, how awful was their position. They knew what were their feelings in the presence of strangers, and they knew how great the trial was of going into an unknown world. If they did not learn to accustom themselves to the idea of an Infinite Father, an Infinite Son, and an Infinite Holy Ghost, what a loss it was in the prospect of the next world. It was a great mystery of God, and miserable were those who did not feel it. Therefore, in order that they might not come to an unknown place those truths were mercifully told them. First of all was knowledge of God and love of God. If they abused their reason, if they got habits of unbelief or complaints, or despair, or of those heresies and dreadful imaginings concerning Almighty God, how terrible was the prospect. Was it possible that anything could be true which was against the constitution of their minds? They could not deny that religion was required of them. It was part of themselves. The spirit was part of themselves; and, therefore, it was consistent with their nature to believe and to rejoice in believing. It was the attributes of Almighty God that ought to be to them solace and strength. Where should they be without love of God? They knew here how miserable it was to live alone. He knew that many people in a certain measure could be happy in themselves, but to the individual society of some kind was quite a necessity. To be alone was a punishment so severe that though it was once given to culprits or criminals, it was now not so given. Solitary confinement would drive a man mad. So now they must think what would be the state of their souls hereafter if they had nothing to rely upon, if they had nowhere to go to, if they had no one to pray to, if they had withheld prayer in this life, and they could not free themselves from the moral responsibility of those dreadful things in which they had indulged; they could not think of Him, they could not pray, they could not remember, and if they did they had formed in their minds such very different ideas of truth and holiness that they could not love Him. They knew bold men would say, “We will go to hell rather than believe this,” but where would such sayings be when the Almighty God Himself came? His Eminence quoted several passages from the Psalms and Holy Writ, and in conclusion remarked that the word “Eternity” was often on their lips, but they did not recollect that eternity itself was a dreadful, an awful thing to contemplate. It was Almighty God Who was the strength of eternity, and if they lived without His Word—without the vision of God—if they were without the love of God, what was eternity but misery? Let them take care that immortality might be a mercy to them and not a

curse. Man might live a long life, but when he looked back upon it he thought nothing of it all. He besought them to beg of Almighty God to touch their hearts, and to create in them the beginning of a new life. He hoped God would bless them.

In the evening Cardinal Newman took his text from the 10th chapter of the Gospel according to St. John, the 14th and following verses.

HIS EMINENCE said they knew that Almighty God not only created them in His mercy, which they expected from Him, but with a still greater mercy did not leave them to themselves. He did not leave the world to itself, but He watched over those whom He had made; there was His providence and His covenant. He showed by the workings of their nature what was right, and what was holy and true, and by His grace He enabled the whole human race of man to do enough for its own salvation. Such was the mercy and providence for the whole world, but besides that they knew that He had from the beginning a chosen people. He had chosen them Himself whom He had decreed to be brought closer unto Himself, and to receive greater privileges. They read the record and history of that very abundant grace of His, in Scripture, and of that providence and that careful moral governance which He exercised over His own. He had called Him Whom He had elected a characteristic name by which was signified that more intimate mercy and love which He had for His people—that was the name of “Shepherd.” He called Himself in the Holy Scriptures “the Shepherd of Israel.” They were the sheep of the Pastor. They could recollect many passages of the Old Testament to the same effect. There was that beautiful Psalm, the 23rd. David said: “The Lord is my Shepherd, and I want nothing. He hath set me in a place of pasturage. He hath turned me out to the water of refreshment. He hath comforted my soul. He hath led me on to the paths of justice for His name’s sake; for, although I should walk into the midst of the shadow of death, I will not fear, for Thou art with me. Thy rod and Thy staff they have comforted me.” That is the special character which Almighty God took upon Himself with regard to His chosen people. It was the gracious continuation of His mercy and providence. He spoke of them as knowing them, and hence it was that it showed a remarkable love for those who were proved by their works. The preacher referred to Abraham, Isaac, Jacob, as pre-eminently shepherds. Again, Moses was a shepherd. David when a youth was a shepherd. God thus singled them out as if peculiar to Him—those who were entitled to that office; and, of course, He thus in His great providence, in His mercy, showed that He meant to extend His mercy upon those whom He chose to guide others. He called them shepherds. They knew that in the prophet Ezekiel a great deal was said about shepherds. The Bishop was specially called a shepherd. But the infinite fulness of the title was in Almighty God Himself. When Our Lord came He called Himself the Good Shepherd; and if they had read that, not having heard about God—supposing that it was not the teaching of the Church; supposing they were left to conjecture when they found Our Lord calling Himself especially the Shepherd—it would be obvious to them to consider that it was a title which was peculiar and characteristic of Almighty God. When David was called a shepherd, he was one of those who were chosen to be a representative by Divine grace, a Vicegerent, a Vicar of the True Shepherd; and they knew that was the case, though in another aspect of his character he was a man of blood. There was One only holy, only the Almighty God Himself; therefore, though David was thus chosen, and honoured, and raised by God, he, of course, was not necessarily what a shepherd ought to be. He brought not good, but evil upon his people. When the pestilence took place on account of David’s sin, he said, “These sheep, what have they done?” He felt that he had not fulfilled his office of being a true and faithful shepherd of the sheep, it still being true that he was a shepherd, and that he was a

man after God's own heart. Now, that being the state of the case in the Old Testament, in the old dispensation, yet He appointed others to take His place. When they came to the New Testament there a Man appeared who was Almighty God. Almighty God, Our Lord Jesus Christ, assumed the title Himself. The preacher did not recollect that He anywhere spoke of all the Apostles as being shepherds, though, of course, in one sense they were shepherds, too; but He did not give the name to all of them. When in St. Matthew He spoke of St. Peter as the rock, He did not speak—it was not His will then to speak—of St. Peter as the shepherd, but he thought it very remarkable, and a point demanding very great consideration, that there was one passage they knew, in which Our Lord committed His sheep to one of His Apostles. He says, "Feed My sheep." He said it to St. Peter. He (His Eminence) did not on consideration find anything parallel to that in the case of the other Apostles. There was that great characteristic title of Almighty God, that office which He exercised towards His elected people, towards those whom He described as His sheep. That title, that office, He delegated on His going away to one of His Apostles, and he was St. Peter. He saw nothing like such a delegation of so especial and so peculiar an office to any other Apostle. The Church acknowledged St. Peter as the Pastor, and according to the law of the Church, the rule of the Church, the Shepherd; and when they came to look back upon the passage in which He thus delegated His office, which made St. Peter what he might call a Vicegerent or Vicar, there seemed to be occasion for it, for He was going away; therefore, He did it. When He was going away they knew that He said, "All power is given to Me in Heaven and earth." He would be with His Apostles till the end of time—always. It did not seem to accord. St. Peter had not neglected his sheep, for the sheep had not yet been given. It was sometimes said it was the restoration of St. Peter after his fall; his fall was the denial of his Lord, and had no connexion with the bringing of others into the Church, which Our Lord emphasised three times in those words in which He gave him the charge, and which had some correspondence to St. Peter's three denials; but still there was involved, notwithstanding the circumstances of his denial, the charge to St. Peter, and not to the Apostles generally. Then it seemed remarkable that that high gift should have been given in the Old Testament. They knew that it was given by God to David, who became the Vicegerent of Almighty God. It seemed to him that that passage was parallel to that which regarded St. Peter. They knew that Our Lord had a treble office: He was the king, the prophet, and the priest, and the word shepherd combined all these things, and was explained in the Psalm that he had read to them. He had the office of ruling, He had the office of feeding, because they knew that a shepherd fed his sheep; and thirdly, in those countries they knew that the shepherd's office was one full of great danger. He had to defend his sheep from the wild beasts. As in the case of David, he had to take care of his pastorate, and to defend his sheep from the inclement weather. In the case of Jacob, there was a great deal of danger in the office of shepherd. It was an office which would really be given to the representative of Our Lord. It was something that seemed to him different from any other office which was given to anyone else under the new covenant. They were all there Catholics, and they all believed it, and there was no need to say this in order to strengthen their faith; but it was pleasant and a cause of thanksgiving that they could contemplate and consider this, which was a matter of faith. The Apostles died off; and, therefore, there must in the nature of things be a succession, and then he wanted to know, if Bishops were to succeed, why was not the head of the Apostles to have a succession? Somewhere they must look for that succession; that seemed plain. When they had reason to believe a thing it was a great confirmation to find from the nature of the case that it must be according to their apprehension. It must be considered that no large body could exist without a head. There were small republics, but when a small polity

became large, the tendency was, from the necessity of the case, to have a head. They knew that when the great Roman Empire had conquered the known world it could not get on without a head. There must be a centralisation of power. The great Republic on the other side of the world could not get on without a head and humanly speaking, unless Almighty God moved by miracles, he did not see how the Catholic Church could possibly get on without a central authority. From the nature of the case this seemed to be as clear as possible to the eye of reason. He had no need to say those things to Catholics such as they were, but they all had various necessities of, he was going to say, controversy; they might be asked questions, and St. Peter told them that they should have an answer for questions. They all had to do good if they could, and they could not do more good than by bringing souls into the ark of salvation. They knew the blessedness, beyond measure, of the principles of the Church. In conclusion, His Eminence said, "Your faith depends not upon reason, but upon the Word of God; and may God bless you."

On the Conversion of England

At a meeting of the Catholic Union, held in Willis's Rooms in May, 1880, under the presidency of the Duke of Norfolk,

HIS EMINENCE (who on rising was greeted with cheers again and again repeated) delivered the following address: When I say to you, Gentlemen, that the question to which I shall ask your attention bears upon the subject of the conversion of England to the Catholic faith, you will think, perhaps, I am venturing without necessity upon difficult and dangerous ground—difficult because it relates to the future, and dangerous from the offence which it may possibly give to our Protestant brethren. But a man must write and speak on such matters as interest and occupy his mind. At the time when you paid me the great compliment of asking me to address you, you were aware what it was that you were asking; you were aware what I could attempt and what I could not attempt; and I claim in consequence, and I know I shall obtain, your indulgence in case you should be dissatisfied, whether with my subject or with my mode of treating it. However, I am not going to consider the prospect of this country's becoming Catholic, but to inquire what we mean when we speak of praying for its conversion. I cannot, indeed, say anything which will strike you as new, for to be new is to be paradoxical; and yet, if I can bring out what is in my mind, I think something may be said upon the subject. Now, of course it is obviously an act of both simple charity and religious duty on our part to use our privilege of intercession on behalf of our own people: of charity, if we believe our religion is true, and that there is only one true religion; and of strict religious duty in the case of English Catholics, because such prayer is expressly enjoined upon them by ecclesiastical authority. There is a third reason which comes to us all, accompanied with very touching and grateful remembrances. Our martyrs in the sixteenth century, and their successors and representatives in the times which followed at home and abroad, hidden in out-of-the-way nooks and corners of England, or exiles and refugees in foreign countries, kept up a tradition of fervent prayer for their dear England down almost to our own day, when it was taken up from a fresh beginning. It was a fresh start on the part of a holy man, Father Spencer, of the Passionists, himself a convert, who made it his very mission to bring into shape a system of prayer for the conversion of his country; and we know what hardships, mortifications, slights, insults, disappointments he underwent for this object. We know, too, how, in spite of this immense discouragement, or rather, I should say, by means of it—for trial is the ordinary law of Providence—he did a great work—great in its success. That success lies in the visible fact of the conversions which have been so abundant among us since he entered upon his evangelical labour, coupled as it is with the general

experience which we all have in the course of life of the wonderful answers which are granted to persevering prayer. Nor must we forget, while we bless the memory of his charity, that such a religious service was one of the observances which he inherited from the Congregation which he had joined, though he had begun it before he was one of its members; for St. Paul of the Cross, its founder, for many years in his Roman monastery had the conversion of England in his special prayers. Nor, again, must we forget the great aid which Father Spencer found from the first in the zeal of Cardinal Wiseman, who not only drew up a form of prayer for England, for the use of English Catholics, but introduced Father Spencer's object to the Bishops of France, and gained for us the powerful intercession of an affectionate people, who in my early days were considered, this side of the Channel, to be nothing else than our national enemies. The experience, then, of what has actually come of prayer for our country, in this and the foregoing generation, is a third reason, in addition to the claim of charity and the duty of obedience, for steadily keeping up an observance which we have inherited. And now, after this introduction, let us consider what it is we ask when we ask for the conversion of England. Do we mean the conversion of the State, or of the nation, or of the people, or of the race? Of which of these, or of all these together? —for there is an indistinctness in the word "England." And, again, a conversion from what to what? This, too, has to be explained; yet I think that at all times, whether in the sixteenth century or in the nineteenth, those who have prayed for it have mainly prayed for the same thing; that is, I think they have ever meant, first, by conversion, a real and absolute apprehension and acknowledgment as true, with an internal assent and consent, of the Catholic creed and an honest acceptance of the Catholic Roman Church as a Divinely-ordained exponent; and next, by England, the whole population of England—every man, woman, and child. Nothing short of this ought to satisfy the desire of those who pray for the conversion of England. So far our martyrs and confessors and their surroundings of the sixteenth, seventeenth, and nineteenth centuries are at one with each other. But so abstract an object is hardly all they prayed for. They prayed for something concrete, and so do we; but, as times and circumstances have changed, so has what is possibly desirable, assignable, changed as regards the object of their and our prayers. It must be recollected that the sixteenth and following centuries have been a period of great political movements and international conflicts, and with these movements and conflicts and their issues religion has been intimately bound up. To pray for the triumph of religion was, in time past, to pray for the success in political and civil matters of certain sovereigns, governments, parties, nations. So it was in the fourth century, when Julian attempted to revive and re-establish paganism. To pray for the Church then was to pray for the overthrow of Julian. And so, in England, Catholics in the sixteenth century would pray for Mary, and Protestants for Elizabeth. But those times are gone. Catholics do not now depend for the success of their religion on the patronage of sovereigns—at least, in England—and it would not help them much if they gained it. Indeed, it is a question if it succeeded here in England, even in that sixteenth century. Queen Mary did not do much for us; in her short reign she permitted acts as if for the benefit of Catholics which were the cause and the excuse for terrible reprisals in the next reign, and have stamped on the minds of our countrymen a fear and hatred of us, viewed as Catholics, which at the end of three centuries is as fresh and keen as it ever was. Nor did James II. do us any good in the next century by the exercise of his regal power. The event has taught us not to look for the conversion of England to political movements and changes, and, in consequence, not to turn our prayers for it in that direction. At a time when priests were put to death, or forced out of the country if they preached or said Mass, there was no other way open for conversion, but the allowance or sanction of the Government; it was as natural, therefore, then to look for

political intervention, to pray for the success of dynasties, of certain heirs or claimants to thrones, of parties, of popular insurrections, of foreign influence on behalf of Catholics in England, as it would be preposterous and idle to do so now. I think the best favour which sovereigns, parliaments, municipalities, and other political powers can do us is to let us alone. Yet though we cannot, as sensible men—because times have changed—pray for the cause of the Catholic religion among us with the understanding and intention of those who went before us, still, besides what they teach us ethically as to perseverance amid disappointment, I think we may draw two lessons from their mode of viewing the great duty of which I am speaking—lessons which we ought to lay to heart, and from which we may gain direction for ourselves; and on those I will say a few words: and, first, they suggest to us that in praying for the conversion of England we ought to have, as they had, something in view which may be thrown into the shape of an object present or immediate. An abstract idea of conversion—a conversion which is to take place some day or other, without any conception of what it is to be, or how it is to come about—is to my mind very unsatisfactory. I know, of course, that we must ever leave events to the Supreme Disposer of all things. I do not forget the noble lines

Still raise for good the supplicating voice,
But leave to Heaven the measure and the choice.

But this great precept does not interfere with our duty of taking pains to understand what we pray for, what our prayer definitely means. And the question is, not what we shall get, but for what we shall ask. The views of our predecessors were clear enough. On the other hand, a want of distinctness is not only unjust to our object, but is very likely, very apt, to irritate those for whom we pray, as if we had some secret expedient and method against them; or else, as if we were giving expression to a feeling of superiority and compassion for them, and thus betrayed ourselves to the resources alone left to men who have been beaten in argument. Now certainly those who prayed for the accession of Mary Tudor or Mary Stuart to the Throne of England did not lay themselves open to this charge. They were definite enough in their petitions, and would have been quite satisfied with the ordinary acts of Providence in their favour, such as are the staple of the world's history. And this is the point as to which I think they give us a second lesson for our own profit. I consider, then, that when we pray we do not ask for miracles, and that this limitation of our prayers is neither precisely to Divine mercy, nor to any want of faith. I do not forget the displeasure of the prophet Eliseus with the King of Israel, who smote the ground only three times with his arrow, instead of more times. "If thou hadst smitten five, six, or seven times," says the prophet, "thou hadst smitten Syria even to utter destruction, but now three times shalt thou smite." But in this case there is no question of miracles. Nor will it be to the purpose to refer to the parable of the importunate widow, and that has nothing to do with miracles either. What I would urge is this. The Creator acts by a fixed rule, which we call a system of laws, and ordinarily and on the whole He honours and blesses His own ordinance and acts through it, and we best know Him when we follow His ordinance in looking for His presence where He has lodged it. Moreover, what is very remarkable, even when it is His will to act miraculously, even when He outstrips His ordinary system, He is wont to honour it even while overstepping it. Sometimes, indeed, He directly contradicts His own laws, as in raising the dead; but such rare acts have their own definite purpose, which makes them necessary for their own sake; but for the most part His marvels are rather what may be called suggestions or carryings out to an extreme point of the laws

of nature than naked contrarieties to them. And if we would see more of His wonder-working hand we must look for it as thus mixed up with His natural appointments. As Divine aid given to the soul acts through and with natural reason, natural affection, and conscience, so miraculous agency is in many, nay, in most cases a co-operation with the ordinary ways of physical nature. As an illustration, I may take the division of the waters of the Red Sea at the word of Moses. This was a miracle; yet it was effected with the instrumentality of a natural cause acting according to its nature, but at the same time beyond it. "When Moses," says the sacred writer, "had stretched forth his hands over the sea, the Lord took it away by a strong and burning wind, blowing all the night, and turned it into dry ground." The coincidence that it happened at so critical a time, and in answer to prayers, and then the hot wind's abnormal and successful action—all this makes it a miracle; but still it is a miracle co-operating with the laws of nature, and recognising while it surpasses them. If the Almighty thus honours His own ordinances, we may well honour them too; and, indeed, this is commonly recognised as a duty by Catholics in the case of mediæval wonders, not to look to miracles until natural means had failed. I do not say that they neglect this rule in regard to their prayers for conversion, but they have not it before their minds consistently and practically. For instance, prayers for the conversion of given individuals, however unlikely to succeed, are, in the case of their relations, friends, benefactors, and the like, obviously a sacred duty. St. Monica prayed for her son. She was bound to do so, and, had he remained in Africa, he might have merely exchanged one heresy for another. He was guided to Italy by natural means, and was converted by St. Ambrose. It was by hoping against hope, by perseverance in asking, that her wish was gained, that her reward was wrought out. However, I conceive the general rule of duty is to take likely objects of prayer, not unlikely objects, about whom we know little or nothing; but I have known cases where good Catholics have said of a given Protestant—"We will have him," and that with a sort of impetuosity, and as if, so to say, defying Providence, cases have always reminded me of that doctrine of Hindu theology represented in Southey's poem, that prayer and sacrifices had a compulsory force on the Supreme Being, as if an implicit act of resignation were not necessary in order to make our intercession acceptable. If, then, I am asked what our predecessors in the Faith, were they on earth, would understand now by praying for the conversion of England, as two or three centuries ago they would have understood by it the success of those political parties and measures with which that conversion was bound up, I answer that they would contemplate an object present, immediate, concrete, and in the way of Providence; and it would be, if worded with strict correctness, not the conversion of England to the Catholic Church, but the growth of the Catholic Church in England. They would expect again, by their prayers, nothing sudden, nothing violent, nothing evidently miraculous, nothing inconsistent with the free will of our countrymen, nothing out of keeping with the majestic march of slow but sure triumph of truth and right in this turbulent world. They would look for the gradual, steady, and sound advance of Catholicity by ordinary means and scenes, which are probably acts and proceedings which are good and holy. They would pray for the conversion of individuals, and for a great many of them, and out of all ranks and classes, and those especially who are, in faith and devotion, nearest to the Church, and seem, if they do not themselves defeat it, to be the objects of God's election, for a removal from the public mind of all prejudices about us, for better understanding of what we hold and what we do not hold, for a feeling of goodwill and respectful bearing in the population towards our Bishops and priests, for a growing capacity in the educated classes of entering into a just appreciation of our characteristic opinions, sentiments, ways, and principles; and in order to effect all this, for a blessing upon our controversialists, that they may be gifted with an abundant measure of prudence,

self-command, tact, knowledge of men and things, good sense, candour, and straightforwardness, that their reputation may be high, and their influence wide and deep, and as a special means, and most necessary for our success, for a larger increase in the Catholic body of brotherly love, mutual sympathy, unanimity, and high principle, rectitude of conduct, purity of life. I could not have selected a more important subject to bring before you; but in proportion to my sense of its importance, is my consciousness that it deserves a treatment far superior to that which I have given it. I have done as well as I could, though poor is the best.

In reply to a vote of thanks moved by the Earl of Gainsborough, and supported by Mr. Charles Langdale and Canon Macmullen,

HIS EMINENCE said he was sure they would not take the few words he might use as the measure of his feelings on such an occasion. Their words had given him great consolation, and he thanked them all from his heart. He did not stand to weigh how far all that had been said in his favour, and all the kind thoughts and feelings that had been expressed, were such as he could in his own conscience take entirely or not. They must all endeavour to do their duty, and try to do good to those around them, and God would reward them.

On the Need of Discipline

Preaching at St. Bernard's Seminary, Olton, June 21st, 1880, the Cardinal said:

MY DEAR CHILDREN,—I wish I were quite the person to speak upon that subject to which I am drawn to say a few words. I say I wish I were the person, because I have not that experience of seminaries which alone could enable one to do so properly and perfectly. And yet I do wish to say a few words, and if they are in any respect not appropriate, I must be pardoned if I do my best; and they will not be many words. I should like, if I could, to bring out what I conceive to be some of the moral advantages of a seminary such as this. But, of course, the obvious, and what seems the first, object of such seminaries is that those who go forth to fight the battles of God, and to be good soldiers of Jesus Christ, may be prepared to teach. The idea of teaching comes first in the idea of a minister of God, and without a knowledge of theology we cannot teach. And, therefore, theological teaching may be said to be the obviously first and *primâ facie* idea of a seminary. But still I conceive that the moral advantages are not less to be estimated, and that, too, for the sake of the objects which we all have in teaching and knowing theology, for the sake of impressing the Faith and discipline of the Holy Church upon our people. Of course, nothing can be said strong enough about the advantage of having it set forth by those who are properly prepared to do so. Now there are a great many advantages such as this, and though I daresay I shall not name those which are the most important, I would name some of those which strike me. And first, to take a large sense of the word, a seminary is a place of discipline. We all need discipline. We want discipline for this world even. And we know that this idea is felt so strongly in the world, even by those who are not Catholics, that the experience and discipline of schools are necessary for getting on in this world. We know what great advantage accrues to our own country by its particular scholastic system, and how foreign nations are looking to try, if they can, to transplant our own rules and principles and practices which so succeed in England. Now, of course, the bringing of a number of boys together is only in itself a misery and a deceit if it is nothing more than to prepare them for this world. We are all sons of Adam, and we know that evil bursts forth of itself when any number of persons come together, and we call such a number of persons "the world." For that is the real idea of the world. There is a natural impulse and principle of our heart exemplified in the fact that persons are drawn together, and enabled to hold converse, so to say, with each other;

and, therefore, to form a rule, a moral rule; not the right rule, but still an ethical rule holding a sort of principle for admiration. Those great schools that are merely secular have such great evils attending them that it is difficult to pronounce an opinion upon them. And all that I can say about them is, that, perhaps, things would not be better if the boys who went there remained at home. It has been so, I do not know what it is now. There is a great advantage, I say, in the mere fact of a number of young people coming together, putting aside the other aspect of the evil of it. Now, in a seminary there are great advantages which overcome that evil, and, therefore, we may look upon it only on its good side. It is truly good because it has great safeguards—the safeguards not only of the Catholic religion—but the safeguards of the personal piety of those young people who come and devote themselves to God, in the flower and springtide of their youth. They give up themselves and all they are to the glory of God and His service, and that will, of course, be seen and blessed by God from Whom it comes. I need not go through the other safeguards. Now I think the first advantage that strikes one is the collision of mind with mind. Let us be ever so well inclined, ever so good and holy, and acting ever so well, and with a view to please God, and with a rule of life such as we ought to have; still there is a great deal to do in the way of disciplining our hearts, which we only gain by being brought together. Everyone likes his own way; and, of course, it becomes an impossibility for everyone to have his own way when there are a great many to be consulted. And, therefore, the very collision of mind with mind is a great advantage. And though it brings a soul into a certain degree of temptation, yet it is a temptation which turns to good from its being wrestled with and overcome. And another advantage is that we all have our own tastes, our likes and dislikes; and no number of minds can come together without having their likings and dislikings overcome. We have to look at things in a higher light. And then, again, I have not said anything yet about the necessity of obedience to superiors. There again is a great field of Christian virtue. And we know—to take an instance, of which I could say much—of my own dear Father, St. Philip Neri—how it was that he tried exceedingly his people merely from principle, to prove if they were obedient, without reference to whether the things were great or little. And so there is one large field, which I think is a most obvious one to put before us as to the advantages of a seminary; and I do not think it can be exaggerated. And then, again, I think there is a great gain which can be gained only by belonging to a body. I do not mean theology strictly, but that settled fundamental basis of viewing things morally and religiously, which we get by habitual contact with others who are of the same profession with ourselves. Men of the world who know very little about religion—I mean Protestants—do not know what they do believe or what they do not; or if they do, they do not understand whether it is important or not. But with a Catholic not only everything is mapped out, but everything is a part of his mind almost. And that is a great gain which those have who by God's mercy are brought into the Church from the beginning. Their minds are framed in a particular way. The whole plan, both of faith and knowledge, becomes part of themselves, and on that I think a great deal might be said. Well, then, I come to a fourth point. There was a poor wanderer, one not in the Church, who when God was good to her said "Thou art He that seest me." This is the case of Agar. She ran away from her mistress, without a friend in the world; she was in despair; and when the angel of God appeared to her and said, "Whence comest thou? and whither goest thou?" she was so overcome with the thought that in her misery there was One who had His eye on her, that she called the name of the Lord that had spoken, "Thou the God Who hast seen me." Then she called the well there (a well being a most important mercy in that country, which we cannot estimate now), "The well of Him that liveth and seeth me." Now it is exceedingly important for all of us to live in the presence of God; and that, I think, is distinct from the moral

advantages and safeguards of which I have been speaking. In the minds of people without religion the idea of God seeing them is quite a thing out of comprehension. They are haunted, possessed with the things that are—things that come before them, with their worldly aims, their worldly duties day by day, with no notion of living in the presence of an Unseen Being; and one would say that everything would go right with God's mercy if a man got that simple gift, that great grace. In the lessons for today, you recollect how, when the medical men told St. Aloysius to think less of God, he said that the thought of God pursued him. There you find what it was in the case of a Saint. Well, it is what all holy people feel in a degree. This is pretty much what St. Paul urges upon us when he says, "Pray without ceasing"; and that, according to my idea, is one especial mercy and gift of a seminary—that you are living in the presence of God, and therefore must believe in the interest of Our Lord and Saviour for you. Without great fault, and miserable neglect of oneself, in spite of the great field of temptation into which any priest goes, there is around him an armour; and St. Paul speaks so much of the armour we are to put on. Well, that is what I say is one work of the seminary, to put on "the armour of God that you may be able to resist in the evil day, and to stand in all things perfect" (Ephes. vi. 13); and if I were to turn the whole object of the seminary into that channel it would be quite sufficient, for it includes in it faith, hope, and charity, according to our measure. I must not be long, but there are one or two things I would just mention. As to theology itself—I think it is a great indirect advantage in this way: I do not mean theology merely as such; but principally because it is our duty, our profession in a certain sense, our occupation in the service of God. When a priest goes into the world, he is usually taken up with so much work that he has no time for anything else. And that is a reason why he should now be taking advantage of those years which he has in the seminary, where the time may be spent profitably, theology thoroughly soaking the mind, so that it is a resource to turn to. Well, I say, he must have a certain degree of theology. He may have no time afterwards; but still from not being strong, or so on, priests may be thrown upon circumstances when they have time upon their hands. Now there is nothing more dangerous than leisure. We have very crafty and subtle enemies; we have enemies within us and enemies without us; St. Paul says that a spirit of evil surrounds us; we have the world, the flesh, and the devil; and it is a great thing if we have acquired the love of theology, so that we may take it up and be interested in it, when we do not know exactly what to do. It requires, of course, more experience than I can have, to speak worthily of such a subject, for it is a great one. That leads me to notice a kind of objection (and it is the last remark I shall make) that it all leads only to a very narrow sort of education, that it is much better with the Churches around us that are not Catholic churches, to have a knowledge of the world; that it is a good thing for those who are going into a religious life—into a ministerial life—to have mixed with the world—that it is good for religion, that it has a certain influence on the laity, and so on. The present day seems to think that those who have a professional education are narrow; they are not fit to cope with others in religious controversy; they do not know anything of the people they have to address. And that is all true. I am not denying that; but still I would say one thing on that point. Of course, I do not see why theology should not so far open the mind as to lead afterwards, at fitting opportunities, to a priest's getting that knowledge of controversy, and so on, which he had not at the seminary. We cannot do everything at once. We begin with the most important, and go on with others. And therefore, in the proper time, and in the proper place, the study of controversy and kindred subjects, and of secular knowledge, becomes very opportune. But still one must remember that there is an innate power, blessed by Almighty God, in a straightforward, well-educated priest, though he knows nothing of the world, or is likely to make mistakes in it. And I think really that many

persons are converted by the simplicity of a Catholic, and especially of a Catholic priest, and his straightforwardly going about his duty, and honestly speaking out what the Church teaches, better than if he were ever so good a controversialist. I am not denying, of course, the great advantage of a knowledge about people, and of a knowledge of their arguments, and the harm that is done by imprudently ventilating a subject when one is not perfectly informed upon it. And bad arguments do a great harm; but a holy life is only a source of good to all who come near it: "Let your light shine before men, that they may see your good works, and glorify your Father Who is in Heaven." May we all enter more into the great responsibility which is put upon us all. How much we can do for God, and how much He will enable us to do, if we put our simple trust in Him.

On Mr. Oules's Portrait of him

On Sunday, June 19th, 1881, the portrait of Cardinal Newman by Mr. W. W. Oules, R.A., which had attracted much interest at the previous yearly Exhibition of the Royal Academy, was presented to His Eminence at Edgbaston. The picture had been subscribed for by members of the congregation, and the presentation was made by Mr. Wilson, who read an address on behalf of the committee appointed for the purpose.

THE CARDINAL replied: My dear Children,—I wish I could return an answer worthy of your acceptable present and of the affectionate words with which you have accompanied it. It is indeed most acceptable to me, and a very thoughtful kindness that you should have proposed to provide a memorial of me for time to come, and a memorial so specially personal, which years hence will bring back vividly the remembrance of the past to those who have known me, and will carry on into the future a tradition of what I was like, to the many who never saw me. It is a second kindness that you wish to leave it as an heirloom to this house, for by doing so you associate my brothers, the Fathers of this Oratory, in your loving thoughts of me, and thereby recognise what is so true, so ever-present to my mind, that you never would have had cause to show affection towards me but for the zealous co-operation of dear friends, living and dead, for the acts and works of whom I get the credit. It is a third kindness that in carrying out your purpose you have had recourse to a man of widely-acknowledged genius, whose work, now finished, is generally pronounced to be worthy of his reputation, and is found by competent judges to claim more and more admiration as a work of art the more carefully it is studied. Nor must I omit a fourth gratification which your address suggests to me. When friends and well-wishers in years past have paid me the like compliment, I have asked myself what I had done to merit it; but now the Sovereign Pontiff has singled me out for his highest mark of favour; and thus while you in 1878 may be considered to have only been anticipating by the honour you proposed to me the coming to me of his act of grace, so now in 1881 I can for the same reason receive it of you without the appearance or the fear of arrogance or presumption. You ask for my blessing, and I bless you with all my heart, as I desire to be blessed myself. Each one of us has his own individuality, his separate history, his antecedents and his future, his duties, his responsibilities, his solemn trial, and his eternity. May God's grace, His love, His peace, rest on all of you, united as you are in the Oratory of St. Philip, on old and young, on confessors and penitents, on teachers and taught, on living and dead. Apart from that grace, that love, that peace, nothing is stable. All things have an end, but the earth will last its time, and while the earth lasts Holy Church will last; and while Holy Church lasts may the Oratory of Birmingham last also, amid the fortunes of many generations, one and the same, faithful to St. Philip, strong in the protection of Our Lady and all Saints, not losing as time goes on its sympathy with its first fathers, whatever may be the burden and interests of its own day, as we in turn now stretch forth

our hands with love and with awe towards those our unborn successors whom on earth we shall never know.

At the London Oratory

On the last Sunday in June, 1881, Cardinal Newman, who was accompanied from Birmingham by Father Bellasis, preached at the London Oratory, after reading from a Pastoral from the Cardinal Archbishop on Catholic education.

THE CARDINAL testified to the great work done by the Cardinal Archbishop for Christian education, and said that an objection commonly made was that, man being a double being, composed of body and soul, and having relations with this world and with the next—why, then, should he not be trained in those things which concern this world by men of this world, and in those which concern the next world by men of the next world? In answer to this objection, he answered that, in fact, it is impossible to separate body and soul, and that the whole tone and drift of the teaching of the Apostles and of our Blessed Lord Himself is, that even the things of this world are to be ordered in reference to God and to the next world; and he quoted the injunction of St. Paul “Whether you eat or drink, or whatsoever else you do, do all to the glory of God;” and “All whatsoever you do in word or in work, all things do ye in the Name of the Lord Jesus Christ, giving thanks to God and the Father by Him;” and also the command of Our Lord himself: “Seek ye, therefore, first, the Kingdom of God and His justice, and all these things shall be added unto you.”

A characteristic of this little discourse was the Cardinal’s habit of looking out the texts of Holy Scripture which he quoted, and reading them from the Bible.

For the last Time

In reply to an address presented to Cardinal Newman by the Catholic Truth Society, on the occasion of a Conference at Birmingham in July, 1890, His Eminence said:

MY DEAR FRIENDS,—I wish, both in thought and language, as far as I can, to thank you, as I do very heartily. I thank you for your affection—it is the affection of great souls. You are not common people. I could say a great deal, but I will only pray that God may sustain and put His confirmation upon what you do. I give you every good wish. Your Society is one which makes us feel the sadness of the days through which we have passed, when the Church of Christ wanted those assistances of publication which Protestants possessed in such abundance. I envied both the matter and the intention of those publications. It is a cruel thing that our Faith has been debarred from the possibility of lively action, but it was no fault of Catholics. They have been so pressed and distracted from the formation of any policy, that the Church has had to depend on only a few heads and the management of a few. This has been the cause of the absence of interest and popularity in publications among Catholics. But now there is no reason why we should not have the power which has before this been in the hands of Protestants, whose zeal, however, I have always admired. But the reward is at hand for us, and we must thank God for giving to us such a hope. I may say of myself that I have had much sorrow that the hopes and the prospects of the Church have shown so little sign of brightening. There has been—there is now—a great opposition against the Church; but this time, and this day, are the beginnings of a revolution. I have had despondency; but the hour has come when we may make good use, and practical use, of the privileges which God has given us. We must thank God and ask for His best blessing and mercy. May He sustain you. God is not wanting if we are ready to work. I beg you to pardon and to forget the weakness of my words.

I am content to pray for you and for your works. God bless you.